

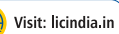
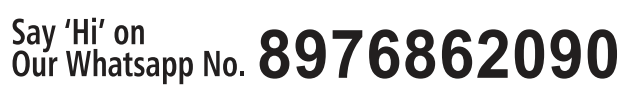
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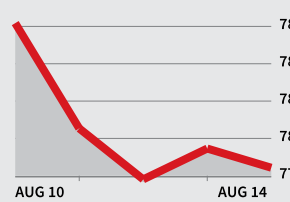






## the hindu businessline

SENSEX 78009.25 (-70.71)



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|                       | LATEST    | CHANGE |
|-----------------------|-----------|--------|
| Nifty 50              | 24366.00  | -29.85 |
| P/E Ratio (Sensex)    | 20.67     | -0.01  |
| US Dollar (in ₹)      | 95.42     | -0.02  |
| Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹) | 151753.00 | -705   |
| Silver 1 kg (in ₹)    | 233842.00 | -386   |

## LEVERAGING AI TECH.

**Fractal Analytics** launches India's first reasoning model focused on healthcare, under the IndiaAI Mission **p12**



## BUYER COMPLIANCE.

**The Centre has asked** sugar mills to ensure that buyers lift stocks within seven days after sales **p10**

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## QUICKLY.

REDUCING LITIGATION  
SEBI to overhaul  
settlement framework

**Mumbai:** The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed a major overhaul of its settlement framework under consent mechanism, replacing the 2018 regulations with a new set of rules aimed at reducing litigation and making it easier and faster for entities to settle enforcement proceedings. These changes include a simpler formula for calculating settlement amounts, a fast-track mechanism for cases up to ₹10 lakh, a settlement notice before a show-cause notice (SCN), a longer 90-day window to apply for settlement, and another opportunity to settle at a later stage if an earlier application is rejected. **p6**



## US names India as a hub routing Chinese goods to evade tariffs

**GREAT SCAM.** MEA says Delhi studying the report and law will deal with violations, if any

**Amiti Sen**  
New Delhi

India is among the over 40 countries named by Washington of helping China circumvent higher US tariffs by allowing Chinese goods to be illegally re-routed through their territories to the American market.

Responding to allegations made against India in a recent White House report, titled *The Great Transshipment Scam*, the Ministry of External Affairs said India had its own robust laws and Customs procedures, and violations are dealt with in accordance with law.

While the report does not break down figures specifically for India, it provides a combined estimate alongside Mexico and Vietnam: "OTEA (Office of Trade and Economic Analysis of the US Commerce Department) estimates that approximately \$67 billion in US-bound goods were transshipped from China through the top hubs — Mexico, India and Vietnam — in 2025, producing an estimated \$28 billion in

## UNDER THE LENS

- While the 'Great Transshipment Scam' does not break down figures specifically for India, it provides a combined estimate alongside Mexico and Vietnam
- Illegal transshipment may involve re-labelling, re-packaging, re-invoicing, minor processing and false country-of-origin claims, the report highlighted
- We would like to study the fine print and the methodology that has been adopted in detail, says MEA



lost tariff revenue," the report noted. The report, prepared under Peter Navarro, said Section 301 tariffs initially reduced the US trade deficit with China, but also encouraged Chinese exporters to exploit tariff gaps by routing goods through third countries.

## THE CHARGE

Illegal transshipment may involve re-labelling, re-packaging, re-invoicing, minor processing and false country-of-origin claims, the report said. India has been in the first tier of countries considered to have elevated risks of China-linked transshipment, alongside Canada, the

European Union, Israel, Japan, Mexico, South Korea and Taiwan. The report, however, cautioned that the risk in these countries is "embedded within broad legitimate trade flows".

While the report doesn't specify concrete action against the countries named, Indian exports could face more scrutiny as the US Customs plans to use shipment data and AI tools to flag goods of possible Chinese origin.

Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India had just seen the report and is studying the details. "We would like to study the fine print and the methodology that

has been adopted in detail. We have robust laws, procedures, governing customs, rules of origin and exports of products. And violations are dealt with in accordance with law," Jaiswal told the media on Friday.

## RE-ROUTING

The report specifically points to India's Pune-Gujarat-Chennai production belt, identifying pumps and compressors as a product category at risk. It maps shipments in these categories to manufacturing corridors in Cincinnati, Dayton and Columbus in the US, suggesting that the alleged re-routing could put American producers of similar goods under pressure.

Trade research body GTRI said India had substantial manufacturing capacity in the product groups flagged by the US, indicating sufficient domestic production for exports. "In FY2026, India exported liquid pumps worth \$1.61 billion globally, including \$414.5 million to the US, while importing \$326.4 million from China," said GTRI's Ajay Srivastava.

## India's exports shifted strongly to Asian, emerging markets in Q1

**Amiti Sen**  
New Delhi

Merchandise exports are showing signs of greater geographical diversification, with shipments to the Asean bloc and North-East Asia (NEA) registering strong growth in the first quarter of 2026-27, led by a sharp increase in dispatches to Singapore and China.

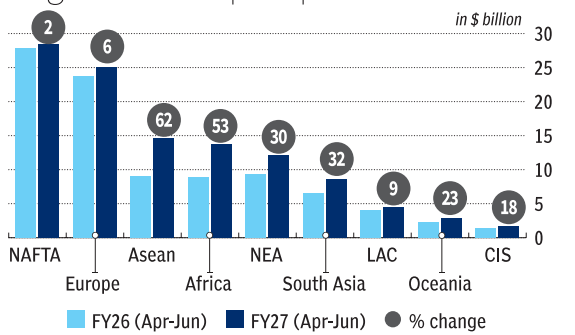
Exports to Singapore more than doubled to \$6.52 billion in April-June 2026-27 from \$3.24 billion in the year-ago period, per government data. Exports to China recorded a sharp increase, rising 27 per cent to \$5.59 billion from \$4.39 billion.

The strong performance in these markets contributed to a broader shift towards Asian and emerging markets, officials highlighted.

## SURGE IN EXPORTS

"NAFTA and Europe retained the highest export values, but grew modestly at 2 per cent and 6 per cent respectively (in the first quarter of FY27). Meanwhile, NEA and South Asia expanded strongly by 30 per cent and 32 per cent, highlighting increasing diversification towards faster growing Asian and emerging

## Region-wise export performance



markets," an official pointed out. Exports to Asean surged 62 per cent year-on-year to \$14.6 billion from \$9.04 billion, making it the fastest-growing major region for Indian merchandise exports during the quarter.

Exports to NEA expanded 30 per cent to \$12.14 billion from \$9.36 billion a year earlier. Africa, too, emerged another strong-performing region, with exports rising 53 per cent to \$13.67 billion in the first quarter.

The shift towards Asian and emerging markets assumes significance as geopolitical tensions, US tariff uncertainties and the West Asia crisis disrupt trade routes, raise shipping costs and lengthen transit times to key markets such as Europe.

India's export growth in

the key Asian markets was markedly higher than overall merchandise export growth that rose 15.9 per cent year-on-year to \$129.32 billion in April-June 2026-27 from \$111.57 billion a year earlier.

## BROAD-BASED GROWTH

The growth across Asean was broad-based. Exports to Malaysia rose to \$2.54 billion from \$1.45 billion, while shipments to Vietnam increased to \$1.95 billion from \$1.30 billion. Exports to Hong Kong, a key NEA market, rose to \$2.24 billion from \$1.49 billion.

Exports to NAFTA countries, while remaining the largest regional market at \$28.41 billion, grew only 2 per cent from \$27.90 billion. Exports to Europe increased 6 per cent to \$25.05 billion.

## With \$52 billion in, RBI to shut concessional swap FCNR(B) window a month early on Aug 31

**Our Bureau**  
Mumbai

The RBI has decided to pull the plug on the limited period concessional swap facility it is offering banks to attract Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank), or FCNR(B), deposits following the robust accretion of \$52.30 billion between June 8 and August 13.

The central bank said that the concessional swap facility will now be available for FCNR(B) deposits of 3-5 years maturity mobilised till August 31, against the earlier deadline of September 30, 2026. Correspondingly, the swaps under this facility, FCNR(B) deposits, may be availed of by banks with the RBI till September 11 against October 16, 2026, earlier.

The move to pre-close the concessional swap facility is likely to set-off a rush among



**CLOSING SOON.** After August 31, banks are likely to revert to old interest rates of about 3 per cent on FCNR(B) deposits **REUTERS**

NRIs to deploy funds in FCNR(B) deposits so as not to miss out on the opportunity to earn higher interest rates of 6-7.5 per cent.

After August 31, banks are likely to revert to old interest rates of about 3 per cent on these deposits. Bankers estimate that banks may mobilise another \$15 billion under FCNR(B) deposits in the next two fortnights, taking the total inflows to about \$67 billion by August-end.

## GOOD RESPONSE

The RBI, in a statement, said that based on the encour-

aging response for FCNR(B) deposits and the resultant forex inflows, it had been decided that the swap facility for FCNR(B) deposits will be available only for deposits mobilised till August 31.

The scheme for external commercial borrowings (ECBs) and overseas foreign currency borrowings will continue to be open till December 31, as hitherto.

On the move to pre-close FCNR(B) deposits, Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, said probably the RBI was targeting a certain quantum of inflows

and may have achieved it.

V Rama Chandra Reddy, Head-Treasury, Karur Vysya Bank, said the early closure of the FCNR(B) window looks more like calibration than a course correction.

"With inflows already crossing \$52 billion, the RBI appears to have achieved the mobilisation objective and is now shifting from attracting flows to managing their liquidity and balance-sheet impact," he said.

An economist with a private sector bank said since the FCNR(B) flows had been very encouraging, the RBI may be encountering a "we don't require so much" situation.

Further, the more this swap takes place, there'll be so much of rupee liquidity also entering the system. So, \$52 billion of FCNR(B) deposits will mean ₹5 lakh crore liquidity getting released into banking system.

## Indian student numbers in US hit 29-month low amid visa delays, immigration policy changes

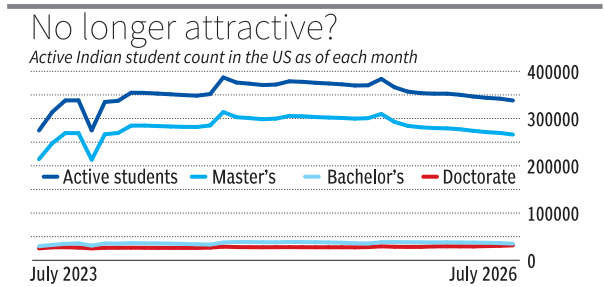
**Sindhu Hariharan**  
**Yashaswani Chauhan**  
Chennai

The number of Indian students in the US seems to be on a sustained decline, with the figure at a 29-month low amid persistent visa appointment bottlenecks and immigration policy changes.

US Homeland Security data show a count of 3,38,230 Indian students in the country as of July, a number that has been falling for 10 straight months since September 2025. This is also the lowest in 29 months.

## TIGHTER IMMIGRATION

A *businessline* analysis shows that since September 2025, the monthly count has been progressively declining as tighter immigration policies and an overall tech job market slowdown have reduced the shine of a US education.



The decline from September 2025 to July 2026 was 12 per cent compared with just a 4.4 per cent fall in the same period the previous year.

Further, the overall Indian student population in the US has fallen 8.6 per cent year-on-year in July. The decline is particularly high among Master's students — the cohort that makes up the bulk of Indian students in the US — with a 11.3 per cent y-o-y fall to 2,66,104.

The number of Bachelor's students is also declining,

but more modestly. The count of doctoral students is rising, suggesting the appeal of the US for research.

## BOTTLENECKS

Sonal Kapoor, Global Chief Business Officer at Prodigy Finance, a lender to international students, said that the US was always the first choice for many students, especially in STEM, but visa delays have changed the locations where they are heading to this year.

In the case of this year's

graduating batch, many are still waiting on US visa decisions, and the process has been slower than expected, she added.

"We are currently speaking to over a thousand Indians aged 15 to 28 for an upcoming report — and an early finding tells us that over 40 per cent have seen their interest in studying in the US dip in the past year, driven directly by visa policy and rising costs," said Avnish Singhal, Head of Consumer Business (India, APAC and Middle East), Emeritus.

## STRATEGIC MARKET

He said global universities now recognise India as a strategic education market and are expanding here by setting up their campuses.

Experts note that the UK, Germany and France are winners of this shift, with more students applying to these countries this year.

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QUICKLY.  
Forex reserves jump  
\$14.14 b to \$707 b: RBI



**Mumbai:** India's forex reserves jumped \$14.136 billion to \$707.002 billion during the week ended August 7, said the Reserve Bank on Friday. The overall kitty had jumped by \$10.512 billion to \$692.866 billion in the previous reporting week ended July 31. The reserves had expanded to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the West Asia conflict that led to several weeks of drop as the rupee came under pressure and the RBI had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales. For the week ended August 7, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased \$9.946 billion to \$574.625 billion. **en**

India-Japan meet held to strengthen skilling

**New Delhi:** The India-Japan Stakeholder Consultation on Skill Development discussed ways to strengthen cooperation on skill development and workforce mobility between India and Japan. It focused on taking forward the action plan for India-Japan Human Resource Exchange and Cooperation. Discussions centred on preparing Indian youth for employment opportunities in Japan through industry-relevant training, Japanese language and cultural preparation and closer coordination among institutions in both countries. “The youth must access global opportunities with the right skills, confidence and preparation,” said Minister for Skill Development and Entrepreneurship Jayant Chaudhary. **en**

# FinMin for easing procedures to select project consultants

LEVEL PLAYING FIELD. Bid to break dominance of group of companies in govt contracts

Shishir Sinha  
New Delhi

In order to break the dominance of a small group of companies in the award of government contracts for consultancy services, the Finance Ministry has issued an office memorandum regarding prescription of qualification and evaluation criteria in the procurement of such services.

Calling this a clear and unequivocal advisory on how consultancies are to be awarded government contracts, Sanjeev Sanyal, Member, Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister, highlighted that qualification criteria for government contracts should be commensurate to the project. “Till now, it was common for eligibility to be restricted through unnecessarily high turnover and payroll requirements that could only be met by a tiny club. This levels the playing field for Indian consultancies and new entrants,” he explained.

KEY FINDINGS  
Addressed to the Secretaries



SEA CHANGE. This a clear and unequivocal advisory on how consultancies are to be awarded contracts, say experts

of all Central government ministries and departments, the memorandum lists three key findings of a sample study of consultancy procurement tenders floated by Central government procuring entities on the Government e Market Place (GeM) in the last three financial years. First, comparatively high turnover requirement was prescribed. Second, higher weightage was assigned to the consulting firm's experience than to the qualification and experience of proposed key personnel.

And third, minimum staff strength on the payroll of the bidder was prescribed as an eligibility criterion, far exceeding the actual manpower required for execution of the project. These “findings indicate that such

eligibility and qualification criteria may unduly restrict competition in the procurement of consultancy services”, said the memorandum. Accordingly, it said that provisions of the 2025 manual may be adhered to while formulating eligibility and qualification criteria for consultancy procurements.

Further, if minimum staff strength on the payroll of the firm is prescribed as an eligibility and qualification criterion, it may be ensured that the prescribed minimum staff strength is commensurate with the manpower requirement necessary for satisfactory execution of the consultancy assignment. “Disproportionately high staff strength requirements, without additional justification, may

unnecessarily restrict competition,” said the memorandum.

According to Suraj Nangia, Founder and Head (Govt and Public Sector Advisory), Nangia Global, for years, government tenders had conditions such as high turnover multiples, rigid staff strength requirements and excessive focus on firm level credentials, tilting the field towards the largest players, regardless of whether those filters were relevant to the work at hand.

This advisory explicitly calls that out and nudges procuring entities to frame eligibility criteria in a way that truly reflects project needs.

PROCEDURAL CHANGE  
For home-grown firms, this is more than a procedural change — it is a strategic opening. “When turnover thresholds are reasonable, staff requirements are linked to real manpower needs of the project, and shortlisting focuses on relevant experience and genuine financial capability, specialised Indian firms can qualify and compete for complex mandates on merit,” said Nangia.

## July WPI inflation drops to 9.78%

Our Bureau  
New Delhi

Wholesale inflation based on the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) dropped a tad to 9.78 per cent in July against 9.87 per cent in June, the government reported on Friday.

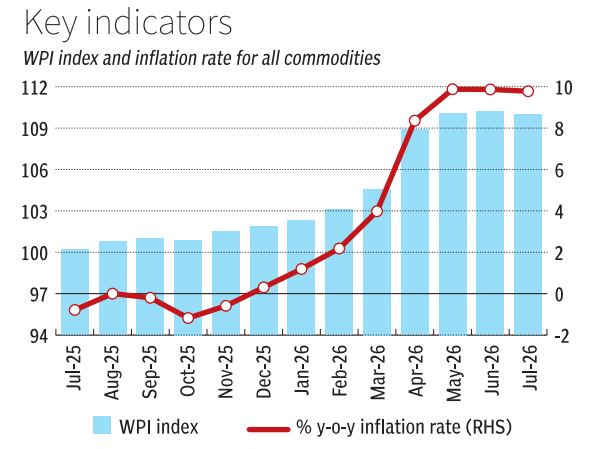
This is the first time that inflation has dropped month-on-month under the government's WPI-based inflation data with the new 2022-23 base year.

Prachi Kele, Lead Economist at PL Capital, felt that wholesale inflation remained uncomfortably high at 9.8 per cent in July, despite a marginal easing from June. It is important to note that manufactured-product inflation accelerated to 8.3 per cent, pointing to persistent cost pressures for producers.

“While WPI does not translate directly into retail inflation, sustained energy and input-cost pressures could gradually feed through to consumer prices if they persist,” she said.

WEST ASIA WAR IMPACT  
WPI has been on an upward trajectory since the beginning of this fiscal as the West Asia war and the resultant blockade of the Strait of Hormuz — through which the majority of crude oil is imported into India — pushed up global crude and fertilizer costs, which had a spillover effect on food prices.

Inflation rates for major groups, namely, primary articles, fuel and power and manufactured products



stood at 8.52 per cent, 20.05 per cent and 8.29 per cent, respectively in July, compared to 7 per cent, 27.41 per cent, and 7.48 per cent, respectively in June.

“Across groups, mineral oils (containing petroleum products), food articles, manufacture of basic metals, non-food articles, manufacture of food products and manufacture of chemicals and chemical products have been major drivers of WPI inflation in July,” said the Commerce and Industry Ministry while releasing the monthly WPI data.

FOOD, FUEL, POWER  
The Food Index consists of food articles from primary articles major group and manufacture of food products from manufactured products major group.

It observed an inflation of 6.65 per cent in July, compared to 6.14 per cent in June. Wholesale inflation in fuel and power dropped to

20.05 per cent in July against 27.41 per cent in June.

However, manufactured products saw an uptick in inflation at 8.29 per cent in July, against 7.48 per cent as in June.

According to Rahul Agrawal, Principal Economist at ICRA Ltd core WPI (excluding food and fuel from headline number), inflation hardened to a series high of 8.2 per cent in July from 7.5 per cent in June amid uptick in prints across 16 of the 21 sub-sectors.

Looking ahead, “we anticipate a larger easing in the WPI inflation to below 9.5 per cent in August after peaking at 9.9 per cent each during May-June,” he said.

Nevertheless, the prints are likely to remain elevated through much of the year, with an average WPI inflation forecast of around 8.5 per cent for FY27, feeding into a high nominal GDP growth figure as well, Agrawal concluded.

## ‘Current account deficit widens to \$6.2 b in June’

Press Trust of India  
Mumbai

India's current account deficit (CAD) widened to \$6.2 billion in June from a surplus of \$1.2 billion in the year-ago month, according to preliminary data released by the Reserve Bank of India on Friday.

The deficit was primarily driven by a widening merchandise trade deficit, which

rose to \$30.2 billion in June 2026 from \$19.2 billion a year earlier. Merchandise exports increased to \$41.2 billion in June from \$35.3 billion in the year-ago month, while imports rose at a faster pace to \$71.4 billion from \$54.5 billion.

The data from the RBI also showed that the surplus in services increased to \$17.9 billion in June 2026 from \$16.2 billion a year earlier.

Services exports rose to

\$36.4 billion from \$32.1 billion, while imports increased to \$18.5 billion from \$15.9 billion. Net transfers also rose to \$11.9 billion in June from \$10.9 billion, while net income deficit narrowed to \$5.8 billion from \$6.8 billion.

NET INFLOWS  
On the capital account front, net inflows stood at \$9.1 billion in June 2026, compared to an outflow of \$1.6 billion in the year-ago month. Net

foreign direct investment stood at \$1.3 billion in June, while foreign portfolio investment recorded a net inflow of \$2.5 billion.

The overall balance was positive at \$2.9 billion in June 2026, against a deficit of \$0.4 billion in June 2025. In April-June, the merchandise trade deficit widened to \$85.7 billion from \$68.9 billion, while the services surplus rose to \$52.2 billion from \$47.9 billion.

## Hormuz disruption puts cost pressure on shipping lines even as freight rates surge

T E Raja Simhan  
Chennai

The disruption around the Strait of Hormuz is putting significant cost pressure on global shipping lines. Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd announced their quarterly financial results on Thursday, reporting higher bunker fuel, insurance, storage, re-routing and inland transportation expenses. This is even as they raised freight rates to pass on a part of the additional costs to customers.

ADDITIONAL COSTS  
German shipping line Hapag-Lloyd estimated that the conflict in West Asia resulted in around \$600 million in additional costs in the second quarter of 2026.

The company said the blockage of the Strait increased expenses across bunker fuel, insurance, storage, service re-routing and



HEAVY BURDEN. Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd carry significant volumes of Indian cargo on their ships REUTERS

inland transportation.

Danish major Maersk said its average bunker price rose 44 per cent to \$777 per fuel-oil-equivalent tonne, while total bunker costs increased 36 per cent to \$2.1 billion in the second quarter. Container-handling costs rose 11 per cent, driven by congestion, higher storage costs and increased volumes.

Both companies carry significant volumes of Indian cargo on their ships. The Hormuz disruption is creating a two-sided cost squeeze

for shipping lines — carriers are seeing higher operating expenses while customers are facing higher freight bills. The ability of shipping companies to pass on these costs through freight rates will determine how much of the financial impact is ultimately absorbed by carriers and how much moves down the global supply chain, said an official with a large freight forwarding company.

The higher cost burden is increasingly being reflected in freight rates. Hapag-

Lloyd's average freight rate increased 9 per cent year-on-year. Maersk's average loaded freight rate increased 22 per cent to \$2,746 per FFE, with East-West rates rising 28 per cent and North-South rates increasing 21 per cent.

ALTERNATIVE ROUTES  
Maersk introduced alternative routing and additional vessel capacity to keep cargo moving. Of the 47,000 containers affected by the disruption, 44,000 reached their destinations through alternative logistics solutions.

The freight market has also responded sharply. The Shanghai Containerised Freight Index doubled from \$1,656 per TEU at the end of 2025 to \$3,240 per TEU at the end of June 2026, reflecting higher oil and transportation costs, as well as exporters bringing forward cargo to protect against further supply-chain disruptions.

## India continues to move ahead as world's fastest-growing major economy: President

Press Trust of India  
New Delhi

Highlighting India's economic resilience, President Droupadi Murmu said on Friday that the country continues to move ahead as the world's fastest-growing major economy, with its growth rate projected to be more than double the global average.

Addressing the nation on the eve of the 80<sup>th</sup> Independence Day, President Murmu noted that warfare and instability prevailing in several parts of the world are affecting every country.

ECONOMIC PROGRESS  
She emphasised that despite such trying circumstances, initiatives like ‘Aatmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan’

(Self-Reliant India initiative) have further strengthened the bedrock of the country's economic progress and national security.

The President's remarks on global turmoil come at a time when the crisis in West Asia, marked by expanding regional conflicts, military instability and heightened maritime security risks across crucial shipping corridors, continues to disrupt global energy supply chains and inflate trade costs worldwide.

Highlighting India's commitment to sustainable growth, she said that while advancing on the path of modern development, the country is playing a leading role at the global level in protecting the environment.

She added that India has

achieved several sustainable development goals (SDGs) targeted for 2030 ahead of schedule, with the develop-

ment of renewable energy gaining unprecedented momentum over the past few years.



KERALA INFRASTRUCTURE INVESTMENT FUND BOARD  
(A Statutory Body under Finance Department, Government of Kerala)  
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Phone: 0471-2780900 e-mail: [financeadmin@kiifb.org](mailto:financeadmin@kiifb.org)  
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**Statement Of Unaudited Standalone Financial Results for the Quarter ended June 30 2026**

The Unaudited Standalone Financial Results of Kerala Infrastructure Investment Fund Board (KIIFB) for the Quarter ended June 30, 2026 (Financial Results) reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee on August 11, 2026 have been approved by the Board Members at their meeting held on August 13, 2026.

The Financial Results along with the Limited Review Report are available on the website of KIIFB under Compliance Tab at: <https://www.kiifb.org/resources/iss> and on the website of BSE at: [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com). The same can also be accessed by scanning the Quick Response Code (QR Code) as provided below:



For Kerala Infrastructure Investment Fund Board  
Sd/-  
**Mini Antony**  
Chief Executive Officer (In-Charge)

Place: Trivandrum  
Date: 13.08.2026



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AS THE NATION CELEBRATES ITS 80<sup>TH</sup> INDEPENDENCE DAY, WE REMAIN STEADFAST IN OUR COMMITMENT TO SAFEGUARD EVERY FRONTIER THROUGH INNOVATION, RELIABILITY AND SELF-RELIANCE.



भारत इलेक्ट्रॉनिक्स  
BHARAT ELECTRONICS

QUALITY, TECHNOLOGY, INNOVATION





# Lending transparency

Disclosures on loan rates to benefit small borrowers

Interest rates on loans and advances on similar products tend to vary greatly across banks, NBFCs and other financial institutions. While part of the variation can be explained by factors such as the differences in sources of funds, risk-profile of the borrowers and the benchmarks used, many lenders misuse the absence of clear guidelines to charge usurious rates.

While banking is a competitive space, customer choice becomes effective only when information is freely available. To this end, the Reserve Bank of India has sought to create a harmonised set of standards for determining interest rates across lenders, including commercial banks, regional rural banks, cooperative banks, all-India financial institutions and NBFCs. A consultation paper on this issue is open for comments. Its wide scope is aimed at ensuring that small borrowers who are not serviced by commercial banks are not cheated. A major suggestion in the paper pertains to asking all regulated lenders to put an upper limit on the annual percentage rate (which includes interest rate, charges and fees) they will charge small borrowers who take loans below ₹50,000, and micro finance loans. RBI must also ask all lenders to display this upper limit prominently on all their banking portals and offices. A proposal stating that the total interest, charges and fees on short-term agricultural loans should not exceed the principal amount will protect small farmers.

The paper makes another welcome suggestion — setting out clear disclosures for calculating marginal cost-based lending rate and asking specified lenders to display the same at the beginning of each month on all platforms. RBI has proposed that MCLR should be the moving average of the costs of domestic deposits and borrowings in the previous three months. But the consultation paper seeks to exempt banks with deposits under ₹1,000 crore and all NBFCs from having to compute MCLR. Instead, they are being allowed to arrive at the MCLR based on their internal policy, requiring the methodology alone to be made public. This exemption goes against the intent to stop mispricing loans, and protecting small borrowers. Similarly, the guidelines provided for arriving at the spread above the benchmark rate charged by lenders could have been more elaborate.

The paper seems to veer towards micro-management. For instance, suggesting that interest rates should be charged every month is not necessary for all types of loans. The lender can determine this, based on the loan category, borrower's profile and preference. Similarly, lenders can be left to determine the interval at which they will reset the benchmark for floating rate loan. They may want to waive interest, in collaboration with vendors. A stipulation that the interest rate cannot be below the benchmark rate, impedes such discount schemes. A balance needs to be struck between transparency and freedom to take competitive business decisions.

## OTHER VOICES.

### The Guardian

Trump wants to keep the easy-money machine running  
Japan's yen has slid back towards 160 to the dollar, despite last month's extraordinary US-Japanese intervention. Traders are betting that its role as a cheap funding pipeline for global finance will continue. Earlier this month the Trump administration stepped in to help Tokyo stabilise its currency. "Japan's been very good to us, with the exception, of course, of Pearl Harbor," Donald Trump explained. More help is likely to be on its way. But this is less a rescue of the yen than an attempt by Scott Bessent, the US treasury secretary, to preserve a cash spigot that benefits the US. Japan's ultra-cheap money has become a global funding utility: bankers borrow yen, sell them for dollars and buy higher-returning US assets, notably tech shares. (LONDON, AUGUST 12)



Missile tests: China needs no one's permission  
Yet another political farce of "a thief crying 'stop thief'" has taken the stage. On Tuesday local time, the US rallied 40 countries to concoct a so-called joint statement on "notifications of ballistic missile launches" targeting China as well as a separate statement. Pointing directly at China's lawful ballistic missile test conducted over the open waters of the Pacific Ocean last month, the statement claimed that China's actions were "incompatible with the responsibilities" and "undermined global stability and security." Meanwhile, in stark contrast, the document painted the US — the country with the highest military spending and the most wars waged in the world — as a "positive role model". (BEIJING, AUGUST 12)

# Digital governance is transformative

FINE LINE. Technology works when it empowers citizens with information and finances, without acting as surveillance tools



Since long, India tried the old-school fixes to bring about transparency and curb corruption: vigilance committees, laws, audits, RTI filings. All useful, nonetheless slow. All still plagued with loopholes which let clerks sit on files and middle-persons siphon-off subsidies. Paper trails vanish, and human systems leak despite the best intentions.

One innovative concept, GeM (Government e-Marketplace), has revolutionised the huge government procurement machinery, historically riddled with malpractices. It has digitised the entire lifecycle — vendor registration, bidding, contract award, payments, performance tracking — and made every step auditable. The by-product is MSMEs, start-ups and women-led businesses, who never had the wherewithal to play the dirty game, benefitting hugely. And it turns out that transparency is a market-access tool also, and not just an anti-corruption one.

The tax system has also been revolutionised. A fragmented, inspector-driven, paper-heavy regime has been replaced by GSTN with digital invoicing and data-driven compliances. Add to that PM Gati Shakti's GIS-based master plan, where roads, railways, ports and transmission lines finally show up on one map instead of in twelve ministries' separate spreadsheets transparency between departments that used to barely talk to each other.

A decade back, when the Prime Minister announced from the Red Fort that one's mobile would be one's bank, very few might have believed it that time. And witness the mighty UPI now. People are actually using mobiles as their banks. The volume has crossed 23 billion transactions and ₹29 trillion per month. It has quietly become one of the most transparent instruments simply by making transactions traceable; pulling cash out of the shadows. And this is the by-product of convenience.

The JAM trinity has almost solved a teething problem — the ghost beneficiary. Duplicate pension claims, fake ration cards, and subsidies siphoned off before they even reached the intended beneficiary. Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) now puts money straight into a beneficiary's account; no middle-person required. The savings



BIG EFFORT. No democracy apart from India has built digital public infra at such a scale

resulting from weeding out duplicate and fake beneficiaries have been estimated at ₹5 lakh crores in the last decade. This is the hard cash that used to vanish earlier into thin air.

DATA AS A PUBLIC GOOD  
No democracy apart from India has attempted to build digital public infrastructure (DPI) at such a scale, so rapidly and for so huge a population. Maturity, however, does not come with scale. A peep outward would be in order.

South Korea, a perennial UN-ranker in digital government, has pushed AI and predictive analytics deep into service delivery, coupled with regular investment in cyber resilience and citizen engagement.

The very crux of digital governance is to ensure, humans no longer override the system quietly. Nothing works, however, if the algorithms making these calls are black boxes

With the platform like X-Road, Estonia, a small East European nation, has been able to bridge the trust gap between government and citizens. Citizens can see when and which agency accessed their data on X-Road in addition to the platform digitising services, generating a two-way transparency; government knows the citizens, citizens monitor the government. Estonians retain trust in the system, thanks to this reciprocity, and not due to the tech itself.

For Singapore, digital governance is a full-blown infrastructure, not an IT upgrade only. It is foundational, with huge investment in cybersecurity from day one and institutional coordination tied together.

The interoperability between systems, real algorithmic accountability, independent audits and grievance redressal that does not end in a call centre queue, are the challenges to be countered head-on; the count of digital rails alone is not enough. A silver lining is that the government is prioritising putting data in public domain, be it on agriculture, health, education, finance, or demographics. No more waiting

endlessly to find out what is actually going on after filing the request; the dataset is already here. Yet, enhancing trust in the system is not a cakewalk; so much remains to be done.

Every one of these systems runs on personal data — loads of it. And this is a double-edged sword. Personal data in irresponsible hands turns into a surveillance system.

Services delivered at speed is what people crave for, but they also want corruption eliminated speedily, alongside freedom and real privacy from the state's prying eyes. Ensured by independent regulatory supervision, the DPDP (Digital Personal Data Protection) framework is not a cosmetic initiative. It is the line between a state that is merely better at watching and the one that is accountable. Get this wrong, and transparency starts being something citizens fear instead of something they trust.

THE AGE OF OMNIPOTENT AI  
The Prime Minister has called AI 'All Inclusive', which now seems to be the one-stop solution for all ills, capable of detecting fraudulent welfare claims in real time, flagging anomalies in procurement before they become scandals and forecasting where corruption is likely to surface next. In a country where land disputes choke the judicial ecosystem, blockchain can make land records genuinely tamper-proof. Satellite imagery now verifies whether a public project is still stuck in file or has seen the light of the day.

The very crux of digital governance is to ensure, humans no longer override the system quietly. Nothing works, however, if the algorithms making these calls are black boxes — becoming the new opaque discretion; unaccountable and unexplainable. The recent incident of Claude getting unauthorised access to systems of three organisations during internal cybersecurity testing, unfolds a more capable AI posing serious threat dimensions.

The 20th century's most transformative governance innovation was the Right to Information. The defining governance idea of the 21st century is DPI, a framework designed so intelligently that citizens need not ask for information because transparency is woven into the system itself.

Technology got India this far. But only institutional discipline will ensure the dream of Viksit Bharat becomes a reality.

Ranjan is Registrar, Indian Institute of Public Administration, New Delhi, and Chatrath is Management Lead at the Canberra Business School. Views are personal

# What FCRA overhaul means for NGO sector

Designated Authority model brings order where there was ambiguity, but concentrates enormous power in a single body

Archana Tewary  
Aishwarya Maria Manjooran

For over a decade, India's Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 2010 (FCRA) has been the gatekeeper for foreign funding flowing into the country's vast non-profit sector, governing roughly 16,000 registered associations and annual inflows of approximately ₹22,000 crore. Already tightened in 2016, 2018, and 2020, the regime now faces its most sweeping transformation yet: the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, introduced in Lok Sabha on March 19, 2026, and the accompanying Amendment Rules, 2026, notified on June 22, 2026, together redraw the regulatory map for every organisation that receives (or hopes to receive) foreign contributions.

The headline change is bold: the Bill scraps Section 15, a bare-bones provision that left asset management largely to improvisation, and replaces it with an entire new Chapter IIIA (Sections 16A through 16L). The government itself acknowledges that the old framework's gaps led to "administrative uncertainty and scope for misuse." Enter the "Designated Authority," a government-notified body that takes custody of foreign contributions and assets whenever a registration is cancelled, surrendered, or lapses. Assets vest provisionally at first,

giving the organisation a window to secure a fresh certificate; fail to do so, and the vesting becomes permanent, with assets transferable to government agencies or sold off into the Consolidated Fund of India. One carve-out: places of worship must have their religious character preserved.

Under the old regime, an expired registration existed in a legal twilight, neither alive nor formally dead. A new Section 14B ends this ambiguity by spelling out three triggers for "cessation": failure to apply for renewal, refusal of renewal, or non-renewal before expiry. Once cessation kicks in, the Designated Authority steps in. Section 12 now also ties prior permission to a specific purpose or amount, with hard timelines for utilisation.

REASONABLE ACTIVITY  
The current Section 35 carries imprisonment of up to five years, often criticised as disproportionate for procedural lapses. The Bill brings this down to one year but widens the net by criminalising the utilisation of foreign contributions in contravention, not just their acceptance. The broader concept of "key functionary" replaces the narrower "director, manager, secretary, or other officer," meaning anyone with control over an entity's affairs can be personally liable. And no FCRA investigation can now be launched without the Central Government's prior



NEW NGOs. The entry gate is narrower

approval. Gone are the days of broad, open-ended registrations. Every association must now lock in a specific purpose and geographical area, selecting from a detailed Schedule of approved activities spanning religious, cultural, economic, educational, and social categories. Already registered? You have one year to declare your purposes and operating geographies, or risk losing your registration. Associations with foreign nationals as key functionaries are now presumptively ineligible, a significant restriction for internationally networked organisations. A "reasonable activity" test requires utilisation of at least ₹10 lakh in the preceding two financial years, a benchmark that could catch out smaller organisations. The 75 per cent utilisation hurdle, backed by mandatory field inquiries before each subsequent instalment, turns disbursement into a performance audit.

Even before these amendments, the

FCRA compliance journey was no walk in the park. Registration refusals and renewal rejections have pushed associations into High Court litigation as recently as 2026, with the Bombay High Court quashing an MHA refusal for lack of procedural fairness.

The 2026 reforms pile further obligations onto this already exacting framework. For 16,000 existing registrants, the one-year declaration window could force genuine operational restructuring. The ₹10 lakh floor will separate active players from paper entities but may also inadvertently catch grassroots organisations on modest budgets.

For newcomers, the entry gate is narrower: a prescribed menu of purposes, the presumptive bar on foreign-national key functionaries, and a cessation mechanism where a missed renewal deadline triggers the Designated Authority to take provisional charge of all assets. The Designated Authority model brings order where there was ambiguity, but concentrates enormous discretionary power in a single body. The lower penalty ceiling is welcome, but the investigation-approval requirement is a double-edged sword: a shield against harassment for some, a potential lever for selective enforcement for others.

The 2026 amendments leave no room for compliance complacency.

The writers are with JSA Advocates & Solicitors

LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to [bleditor@thehindu.co.in](mailto:bleditor@thehindu.co.in) or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Catalysing AI  
With reference to 'US' AI infrastructure bet and lessons for India' (August 14), the AI led American growth story is inspirational and worth emulating. India has been attracting reasonably good global investments in AI, especially in the last one year. But there is an enormous untapped potential. In order to attract massive global investments in AI infrastructure, the availability of

dedicated hyper-scale clean power with near zero downtime and enough water for cooling systems is an imperative. Further, regulatory certainty around data transfers, copyright and AI governance should be assured for the big tech companies to commit investments, apart from facilitating green channels for import of high performance compute infrastructure. Kosaraju Chandramouli Hyderabad

Hydrocarbon exploration  
This refers to 'Exploring options' (August 14). Our indifferent hydrocarbon record is shaped by limited exploration, inadequate technology and tough economics of deep-water drilling. Today 3D seismic imaging, AI analyses, advanced drilling and better reservoir modelling can probe geological structures far accurately than earlier. While technology can improve the probability of discovery and reduce exploration risk, commercial viability

ultimately depends on reservoir size, quality, depth and development costs. R Narayanan Navl Mumbai  
Rural credit access  
With reference to 'Rural credit needs to be reimagined' (August 14), Rural households today depend on diverse livelihoods. Yet credit systems often remain designed around conventional agricultural cycles. Banks should develop flexible

products based on household cash flows rather than treating every borrower as a cultivator. Small loans, working-capital facilities and emergency credit should be available with simple documentation and reasonable repayment schedules. Better use of digital records can improve credit assessment while reducing dependence on informal lenders. Financial literacy and local advisory services are also important. Pon. Arun Kumar Tiruchengode, TN





# Amara Raja sees battery storage plant driving near-term revenue

**POWERING AHEAD.** The upcoming 10 GWh facility has the potential to generate \$500-600 million

**Amit Vijay Mohile**  
Mumbai

Amara Raja Energy & Mobility expects its upcoming 10 GWh battery energy storage systems (BESS) plant to achieve at least 5 GWh utilisation within six months of commissioning, potentially creating a meaningful new revenue stream even as commercial revenue from its own battery-cell manufacturing remains at least a year away.

The ₹250-300 crore BESS facility, scheduled for commissioning in Q3 FY27, will assemble imported lithium iron phosphate (LFP) cells into containerised storage solutions for grid-scale and commercial customers.

### SELLING PRICE

Based on management’s indicated selling price of \$100-120 per kWh, annual deliveries of 5 GWh could imply revenue potential of \$500-600 million, although this is a capacity-based estimate rather than a disclosed order book.

Responding to a JPMorgan query on demand visibility, the management said it is seeing a “reasonable order book” emerge from Indian engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) companies and expects a rapid scale-up after commis-



**UPBEAT PROJECTION.** The management expects reasonable order book emerge from Indian EPC companies and expects a rapid scale-up after commissioningREUTERS

sioning. “I don’t see a major challenge within a period of about six months from the time the factory is completed, at least getting to a level of 5 GWh utilisation,” Chief Financial Officer Y Delli Babu said during the company’s post-results analyst call.

Nomura raised concerns about increasing competition in the BESS market and the profitability of the business.

Management said it is conservatively factoring in operating margins of 5-6 per cent, with 7-8 per cent possible at the upper end.

The business is also expected to operate with a 90-100 day cash-conversion cycle.

The company stressed that the targeted 5 GWh BESS utilisation should not be confused with demand for its own battery cells.

Its first captive-cell facility is a separate 2 GWh cylindrical NMC line focused primarily on mobility applications.

### REVENUE GUIDANCE

Equipment is expected in Q3 FY27, with commercialisation targeted in H1 FY28. The company has yet to disclose customer commitments, utilisation targets or revenue guidance for the line.

The distinction is becoming more important as stationary storage increasingly

favours lower-cost, longer-life LFP chemistry.

While the BESS business will use LFP cells, Amara Raja’s first captive manufacturing line is NMC-based. Management indicated future cell investments could be directed toward energy-storage applications as demand accelerates.

Amara Raja continues to target 16 GWh of cell capacity by FY30 and a 15-20 per cent share of India’s addressable market, but said expansion will remain demand-led.

“Any redundant capacity that we create will be highly taxing on the financials,” Delli Babu said.

The company has guided

FY27 capex of ₹1,700 crore, including ₹1,300 crore for new-energy projects and ₹400 crore for lead-acid batteries and recycling.

About ₹450 crore was spent in Q1, while cell R&D will require another ₹100-150 crore this year. Management acknowledged funding requirements will rise as cell capacity scales.

### FUTURE EXPANSION

The holding company generates an estimated ₹700-800 crore annually after tax and dividends, suggesting future expansion may require debt, equity or other financing. It also estimates Indian cell production remains 15-20 per cent costlier than Chinese supply.

Meanwhile, the legacy lead-acid business continues to fund the transition, with Q1 revenue growing about 22 per cent. New-energy revenue rose over 70 per cent to ₹209 crore, driven mainly by telecom and EV battery packs, and accounted for about 5 per cent of consolidated revenue. While BESS could become a sizeable business before cell manufacturing ramps up, the key test will be converting demand from imported LFP cells to locally manufactured cells while earning returns on its ₹9,500-crore new-energy investment plan.

# Data analytics firm Tredence aims for \$1 b revenue by 2030

**Rohan Das**  
Chennai

Tredence, a data and analytics company, is gearing up for a phase of accelerated growth with an ambition to achieve \$1 billion in annual revenue by 2030.

The US-headquartered niche analytics player, which has a significant presence in multiple Indian cities, including Chennai, has seen its revenue go up over 10x in the last six years from around \$30 million in 2020 to an anticipated range of \$340-350 million in 2026.

Speaking to *businessline*, Shub Bhowmick, Co-founder and CEO, Tredence, said they started out as a pure play analytics specialist, but over the years had widened offerings to include data engineering, MLOps and agent orchestration projects.

### INTEL BUILDING

“In the earlier stages, I would say it was a lot of intelligence building. Then it got to a point where it was not just building intelligence, but enabling our clients to make decisions. Now, it is shifting to a point where it is about integrating those decisions into the business work-



Shub Bhowmick, Co-Founder and CEO, Tredence

flows,” he said. Tredence also wants to move away from the traditional time and material contracts to more outcome-based pricing.

“Internally, we want to change that equation, the proportionality between revenue and headcount. Today, about one-third of my business is still time and money. I want to make it zero over time,” he said.

Around 50 per cent of Tredence’s revenue still comes from data engineering work. The other half comes from AI-related services.

In terms of industry verticals, retail and CPG are the largest segments, though the firm is actively looking to grow its presence in growth segments like travel and hospitality, telecom, media and

tech, healthcare and life sciences, banking and financial services and manufacturing.

As for the geographies, he said that while the US still holds the largest share, both West Asia and Europe have shown strong growth in recent years.

### EYING NEW VERTICAL

Acquisitions will be a key part of this strategy, said Bhowmick. “I am going to keep acquiring some businesses. But acquisitions will not be about acquiring revenue. It will be about acquiring strategic capabilities,” he said, adding that they will acquire for new vertical plays or geographies.

In June, Tredence announced the acquisition of KMK Consulting, a life sciences and biopharma focused analytics and consulting firm, a relatively nascent vertical for the company.

The firm currently employs around 5,000 employees with around 20 per cent stationed in the US and the rest spread across offices in India and a few global delivery centres.

The company is actively training its employees in an effort to make them AI-native and increasing revenues per full-time employee.

## Kovilpatti Lakshmi Roller Flour Mills Limited

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CIN : L15314TN1961PLC004674

Statement of Standalone Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended June 30, 2026

| S. No | Particulars                                                                                                                                  | Three months ended |                |               | Year Ended     |
|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------|---------------|----------------|
|       |                                                                                                                                              | June 30, 2026      | March 31, 2026 | June 30, 2025 | March 31, 2026 |
|       |                                                                                                                                              | (Unaudited)“       | (Audited)“     | (Unaudited)   | (Audited)“     |
| 1     | Total Income from operations (net)                                                                                                           | 9,265.44           | 10,051.50      | 9,995.26      | 41,299.02      |
| 2     | Net profit/ (loss) for the period (before tax exceptional and/or extraordinary items)                                                        | 145.32             | 170.99         | 170.55        | 555.26         |
| 3     | Net profit/ (loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)                                                  | 145.32             | 336.57         | 465.26        | 1,015.55       |
| 4     | Net profit/ (loss) for the period after tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)                                                   | 108.74             | 298.57         | 363.53        | 809.46         |
| 5     | Total comprehensive Income for the period [comprising profit / (loss) for the period (after tax) and Other comprehensive income (after tax)] | 110.88             | 296.79         | 366.98        | 818.03         |
| 6     | Equity share capital                                                                                                                         | 904.15             | 904.15         | 904.15        | 904.15         |
| 7     | Reserves (excluding revaluation reserve)                                                                                                     |                    |                |               | 6,551.99       |
| 8     | Earnings per share (for continuing and discontinuing operations) (of Rs.10/- each)                                                           |                    |                |               |                |
|       | a. Basic                                                                                                                                     | 1.20               | 3.30           | 4.02          | 8.95           |
|       | b. Diluted                                                                                                                                   | 1.20               | 3.30           | 4.02          | 8.95           |

Notes:

- The above is an extract of the detailed format of results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 filed with Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended. The full format of the financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 are available on the website of the BSE Limited i.e www.bseindia.com, on the stock exchange where the Company’s shares are listed and on the website of the Company i.e. www.klrf.in/ Investorcentre. The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.
- . In accordance with SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015, the above unaudited financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, as reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee, has been approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on 14th August 2026. A limited review has been carried out by the Statutory Auditor of the company and have issued an unmodified opinion on the above results.
- Consolidated financial statements is not applicable since the Company has no subsidiary / associate / joint venture company as on June 30, 2026.
- Figures for the corresponding quarter / period ended have been regrouped wherever necessary.

|                                                            |  |                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------|--|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Place : Coimbatore<br>Date : 14 <sup>th</sup> August, 2026 |  | For Kovilpatti Lakshmi Roller Flour Mills Limited<br>Sharath Jagannathan<br>Chairman and Managing Director<br>DIN : 07298941 |
|------------------------------------------------------------|--|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|



3M India Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 48-51, Electronics City, Hosur Road, Bengaluru - 560100  
CIN:L31300KA1987PLC013543 | Website: [www.3mindia.in](http://www.3mindia.in) | Email: [investorhelpdesk.in@mmm.com](mailto:investorhelpdesk.in@mmm.com)

Extract of the Financial Results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026

(Rs. in Crores, except per share data, unless otherwise stated)

| Particulars                                                                                                                                                   | 3 months ended<br>30 June 2026 | 3 months ended<br>30 June 2025 | 12 months ended<br>31 March 2026 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Total income from operations (including other income)                                                                                                         | 1,434.85                       | 1,210.95                       | 5,138.50                         |
| Net Profit for the period (before tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)                                                                              | 229.03                         | 239.40                         | 928.36                           |
| Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)                                                                         | 302.16                         | 239.40                         | 894.03                           |
| Net (Loss) / Profit for the period after tax                                                                                                                  | 233.07                         | 177.69                         | 522.32                           |
| Total comprehensive (loss) / income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income/ (loss) (after tax)] | 233.00                         | 176.48                         | 522.07                           |
| Equity share capital                                                                                                                                          | 11.27                          | 11.27                          | 11.27                            |
| Reserves (excluding revaluation reserves as per Ind AS)                                                                                                       |                                |                                | 1,756.88                         |
| Earnings per share (in Rs.) (of Rs. 10/- each)                                                                                                                |                                |                                |                                  |
| a) Basic (in Rs.)                                                                                                                                             | 206.90                         | 157.73                         | 463.66                           |
| b) Diluted (in Rs.)                                                                                                                                           | 206.90                         | 157.73                         | 463.66                           |

Notes:

1. The above unaudited financial results of 3M India Limited have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and thereafter approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 14 August 2026.

2. The financial results of the Company have been prepared in accordance with Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) as notified by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs pursuant to Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standard) Rules 2015, as amended and in terms of Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

3. The above is an extract of the detailed format for the unaudited financial results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format for the unaudited financial results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026 is available on the Stock Exchange websites viz. [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com), [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com) and on the Company's website ([https://www.3mindia.in/3M/en\\_IN/company-in/about-3m/financial-facts-local/](https://www.3mindia.in/3M/en_IN/company-in/about-3m/financial-facts-local/)). The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.

4. During the quarter ended 30 June 2026, the Company has sold its land located at Pimpri, Pune pursuant to a Conveyance Deed executed on 29 June 2026, for a total consideration of Rs. 82.00 crores. Exceptional item of Rs. 73.13 Crores represents net gain on sale of aforesaid land during quarter ended 30 June 2026.



For and on behalf of the Board

3M India Limited

Aseem Joshi

Managing Director

Place: Bengaluru

Date : 14 August 2026

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                   |               |            |            |               |            |            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------|------------|---------------|------------|------------|
| <div></div> <div><b>ASHOK LEYLAND</b><br/><i>Koi Manzil Door Nahin</i><br/><b>ASHOK LEYLAND LIMITED</b><br/>Regd. Office: 1, Sardar Patel Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032; Ph: +91 44 2220 6000, Fax: +91 44 2220 6001;<br/>CIN: L34101TN1948PLC000105; Website: <a href="http://www.ashokleyland.com">www.ashokleyland.com</a>; Email id: <a href="mailto:secretarial@ashokleyland.com">secretarial@ashokleyland.com</a></div> |                                                                                                                                                   |               |            |            |               |            |            |
| <b>EXTRACT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                   |               |            |            |               |            |            |
| (₹ Crores)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                   |               |            |            |               |            |            |
| Sl. No                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Particulars                                                                                                                                       | Standalone    |            |            | Consolidated  |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                   | Quarter Ended |            | Year Ended | Quarter Ended |            | Year Ended |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                   | 30.06.2026    | 30.06.2025 | 31.03.2026 | 30.06.2026    | 30.06.2025 | 31.03.2026 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                   | Unaudited     | Audited    | Unaudited  | Audited       |            |            |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Revenue from operations                                                                                                                           | 9,634.35      | 8,724.51   | 44,007.03  | 13,069.59     | 11,708.54  | 56,362.08  |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Profit before exceptional items and tax                                                                                                           | 830.18        | 797.73     | 5,162.50   | 949.72        | 891.41     | 5,539.23   |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Profit before tax                                                                                                                                 | 830.18        | 797.73     | 4,814.02   | 949.72        | 891.41     | 5,154.79   |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Profit for the period / year                                                                                                                      | 609.11        | 593.73     | 3,565.53   | 667.77        | 657.72     | 3,720.98   |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Total Comprehensive Income for the period / year [comprising Profit for the period / year (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)] | 599.86        | 580.92     | 3,465.65   | 533.19        | 1,032.97   | 4,594.53   |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Paid-up equity share capital                                                                                                                      | 587.39        | 293.65     | 587.39     | 587.39        | 293.65     | 587.39     |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Other equity                                                                                                                                      | 11,657.47     | 10,519.08  | 12,526.03  | 12,715.10     | 11,375.91  | 13,654.30  |
| 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Earnings per share (Face value per share of ₹1/- each) (not annualised)                                                                           |               |            |            |               |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | a) Basic                                                                                                                                          | 1.04          | 1.01       | 6.07       | 1.05          | 1.04       | 5.91       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | b) Diluted                                                                                                                                        | 1.04          | 1.01       | 6.07       | 1.05          | 1.04       | 5.91       |

**Notes :**  
(1) The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended from time to time. The full format of the financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 are available on the Stock Exchange websites ([www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com) and [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com)) and on the Company's website ([www.ashokleyland.com](http://www.ashokleyland.com)). The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code given below.  
(2) The figures for the previous periods have been reclassified / regrouped wherever necessary.



Place : Chennai  
Date : August 14, 2026

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On behalf of the Board of Directors

**SHENU AGARWAL**  
Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer

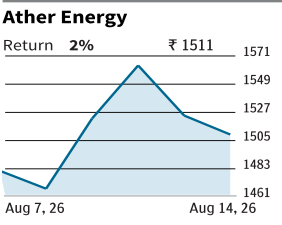


**HINDUJA GROUP**



QUICKLY.

Ather shareholders clear ₹1,200 crore pref issue



**Mumbai:** Electric two-wheeler maker Ather Energy on Friday said its shareholders have approved a ₹1,200 crore preferential issue with 97.72 per cent of votes cast in favour of the resolution at an extraordinary general meeting. The preferential issue, together with the recently completed ₹1,300 crore qualified institutional placement , takes Ather Energy's total fundraising to about ₹2,500 crore, the company said in an exchange filing. The capital raised will support investments in manufacturing capacity, product and technology capabilities, and the balance sheet, it added.

Online bond platforms get nod to deepen products

**New Delhi:** SEBI on Friday eased regulatory framework for online bond platform providers (OBPPs), allowing them to offer products and securities regulated by the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA), as well as certain tax-saving bonds. Under the revised framework, OBPPs can offer products or securities regulated by financial sector regulators, including SEBI, RBI, IRDAI, IFSCA and PFRA. They can also offer bonds issued under Section 54EC of the Income Tax Act, 1961, or Section 85 of the Income-tax Act, 2025, SEBI said. For IFSCA-regulated products, OBPPs will have to follow the norms applicable to SEBI-registered stock brokers operating in GIFT-IFSC.

BROKER'S CALL.

PL Capital

**HIND AERONAUTICS (BUY)**  
Target: ₹5,795  
CMP: ₹5,015.50  
Hindustan Aeronautics (HAL) reported a healthy Q1-FY27 performance, with revenue growing about 14.4 per cent y-o-y, likely supported by improved execution, while EBITDA margin expanded 107 bps y-o-y to 27.7 per cent, aided by lower other expenses. HAL continues to strengthen its position in India's defence and aerospace ecosystem, supported by robust order opportunities of about ₹90,000 crore over the next two years across ALH helicopters, Su-30 upgrades, Dornier aircraft and engine manufacturing programs. LCA Mk1A execution visibility is improving as GE engine supplies normalise, with management targeting production of around 24+ aircraft annually in the coming years. HAL plans cumulative investments of about ₹12,000 crore by 2030 towards capacity expansion, aero-engine infrastructure and next-generation platforms, supporting higher production rates and localisation. Overall, strong order visibility, improving LCA execution, capital investments and rising indigenisation position HAL well for sustained long-term growth, with execution ramp-up and foreign OEM supply remaining key monitorables. We maintain 'Buy' rating valuing the stock at a PE of 36x Mar'28E (35x Mar'28E earlier) as improving GE F-404 engine availability should likely enable a ramp-up in LCA Mk1A deliveries, with HAL targeting higher production of 24+ aircraft annually. This results in a revised TP of ₹5,795 (₹5,423 earlier).

Elara Securities

**MINDA CORP (BUY)**  
Target: ₹926  
CMP: ₹719.75  
Minda Corporation reported its highest-ever quarterly revenue of ₹1,850 crore in Q1FY27, up 33 per cent y-o-y and 8 per cent q-o-q, led by strong performance across core businesses, with Mechatronics & Aftermarket/Information & Connected Systems growing 33/34 per cent y-o-y. Wiring harness and instrument clusters grew over 30/35 per cent, respectively. EBITDA rose 35 per cent YoY to ₹210 crore, while margin stood at 11.5 per cent (above our est of 10.8 per cent), up about 20 bps y-o-y but down 45bps q-o-q, impacted by commodity inflation, higher wage/labour costs and freight, though largely offset by operating leverage and efficiencies. Management highlighted that most indexed commodities have back-to-back pass-through arrangements with customers, albeit with a lag of one-two quarters, which should aid cost recovery. It expects margins to remain in the 11-12 per cent range in FY27, while reiterating its 12.5 per cent EBITDA margin target by FY30. Minda Corp is one of our preferred plays in the ancillary space, supported by its strong positioning across key automotive trends such as premiumisation, electrification, connected systems and rising content per vehicle. The company continues to outperform underlying OEM production growth, aided by healthy order inflows, increasing kit value, market-share gains and expansion into high-growth segments such as EV powertrain, TFT clusters, sunroof systems. We retain Buy with a revised TP of ₹926 (earlier ₹844), valuing Minda Corp at 35x Sep '28E P/E.

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SEBI overhauls consent mechanism, aims to cut settlement costs by 50%

**GOING EASY.** It will fast-track cases up to ₹10 lakh, and offer second opportunity to settle at later stage

**Akshata Gorde**  
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed a major overhaul of its settlement framework under consent mechanism, replacing the 2018 regulations with a new set of rules aimed at reducing litigation and making it easier and faster for entities to settle enforcement proceedings. These changes include a simpler formula for calculating settlement amounts, a fast-track mechanism for cases up to ₹10 lakh, a settlement notice before a show-cause notice (SCN), a longer 90-day window to apply for settlement, and another opportunity to settle at a later stage if an earlier application was rejected.

The move comes after SEBI studied settlement applications filed over the past two years that were rejected or withdrawn and found that the proposed settlement amounts were, on average, about eight times the penalty eventually imposed. This gap is expected to come down to about four times under the proposed framework.

**NEW CALCULATION**  
SEBI has proposed a new method for calculating settlement amounts that takes into account the stage of proceedings, the nature of the violation, aggravating and mitigating factors and the applicable base amount. SEBI is also proposing changes to reduce the weight of some aggravating factors and increase the scope for mitigating factors.



**ON THE FAST TRACK.** SEBI has proposed a new method to calculate settlement amounts that will take into account the stage of proceedings and the nature of the violation

It has also proposed a fast-track settlement route for cases involving settlement amounts of up to ₹10 lakh, provided no non-monetary terms are involved. Such cases would not need to go before the High-Powered Advisory Committee and would move from the Internal Committee directly to a panel of Whole-Time Members. Except for cases in-

volving prosecution and specified fast-track cases, SEBI would inform an entity of the probable charges and give it 60 days to apply for settlement before issuing a show-cause notice. The time available to apply for settlement after an SCN would also rise from 60 days to 90 days. Applicants whose earlier settlement requests were rejected could

Mixed bag for IPO listings as Technocraft jumps 47%, Leap India tumbles 9% against issue price

**Our Bureau**  
Bangaluru

Shares of Technocraft Ventures and Leap India witnessed contrasting debuts on the bourses on Friday, with Technocraft Ventures ending the session nearly 47 per cent above its issue price at ₹311.15, while the latter saw a muted listing and settled 9 per cent below its IPO price. Technocraft Ventures listed with about 34 per cent premium on the BSE at ₹285 and at ₹284 on the NSE against its IPO price of ₹212. The stock closed at ₹311.15 on both NSE and BSE.



**STRONG OPENING.** Radha Kirthivasan (third from right), Head-Issuer Relations & Corporate Sales, BSE, with officials of Technocraft Ventures at the listing ceremony

Though Leap India shares debuted at a 4.4 per cent premium on the BSE at ₹166 and at ₹165.90 on the NSE, above the offer price of ₹159, they closed at ₹145.10 and ₹144.93. Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer, Master Cap-

ital Services, said Leap India's asset-pooling model and pan-India network position it to benefit from the expanding supply chain and logistics ecosystem. He said the Indian pallet market grew from 70 million units (mu) in FY2021 to 106

mu in FY2026 and is projected to reach 164 mu by FY2031, a CAGR of 9.1 per cent. He advised investors to monitor quarterly results to assess the sustainability of margins amid competitive pricing pressure. Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth, Swatika Investmart, has maintained a positive view on Technocraft Ventures, citing its strong listing, attractive valuation at a P/E of around 14.73x, healthy revenue growth, profitability and return ratios. She also said the company is well positioned to benefit from growth in the water and infrastructure development sector.

Behari Lal Engg IPO gets bids for over 108x, Shiprocket subscribed 99 times

**Our Bureau**  
Bangaluru

IPOs of Shiprocket and Behari Lal Engineering that closed on Friday witnessed strong response, led by institutional support. Shiprocket's IPO was subscribed 99.38 times, while Behari Lal Engineering's issue was even better at 108.44 times.

**SHIPROCKET**  
The ₹1,617.5-crore Shiprocket IPO saw the QIB portion receiving bids for 122.80 times, followed by NII 89 times and retail investors 46.42 times. The employee portion was also a huge hit with 55.5 times sub-

SEBI eases InvIT cash flow distribution norms

**Our Bureau**  
Mumbai

SEBI on Friday revised the framework for calculating net distributable cash flows (NDCF) of infrastructure investment trusts (InvITs), allowing certain debt-funded major maintenance expenses for road projects to be added back while calculating cash available for distribution. The move follows requests from industry and recommendations of SEBI's Hybrid Securities Advisory Committee (HySAC). Under the revised framework, payments towards major maintenance expenses for road projects can be added back to NDCF at both the HoldCo/SPV and InvIT trust levels, but only to the extent they are funded by external borrowing. SEBI has, however, prescribed several safeguards. The project must fall under the roads and bridges infra-

structure sub-sector, while major maintenance will mean expenditure that is not routine and is in line with the obligations under the concession agreement.

**UNITHOLDER APPROVAL**  
InvITs will need approval from unitholders before adding such expenses back to NDCF. The approval requires at least 60 per cent of votes cast in favour and must be obtained for each project where the investment manager proposes to raise borrowing for maintenance. SEBI has clarified that the approval can be obtained on a one-time basis for debt already availed or proposed over the project lifecycle, or for a specific maintenance expense. A statutory auditor will also have to certify that the maintenance expenses comply with concession agreement requirements and have been funded through external borrowing.

Overwhelming response (Number of times)

|                        | QIBs   | Non-institutions | Retail | Employee | Total  |
|------------------------|--------|------------------|--------|----------|--------|
| Shiprocket             | 122.8  | 88.99            | 46.42  | 55.51    | 99.38  |
| Behari Lal Engineering | 165.33 | 165.32           | 53.27  | -        | 108.44 |

Source: Exchange

scription. It had fixed the price band of ₹92-97. The issue comprised a fresh issue of ₹885.50 crore and an OFS of ₹732 crore. Shiprocket had raised ₹727.41 crore from anchor investors. The company plans to use the proceeds for marketing initiatives and to strengthen technology infrastructure across its core and emerging businesses. Funds will also be used to

settle debts and for potential acquisitions. **BEHARI LAL ENGG**  
The QIB portion was subscribed 165.33 times, NIIs 165.32 times and retail investors 53.27 times. The company had fixed the price band at ₹271-285 for its ₹302-crore IPO. Earlier, Behari Lal Engineering raised ₹90.48 crore from anchor investors.

Market ends the week in red as Iran tensions, crude keep bulls at bay

**Anupama Ghosh**  
Mumbai

The markets closed the week on a cautious note on Friday, with the Nifty 50 falling for the fourth consecutive session as elevated crude oil prices and escalating geopolitical tensions in the West Asia kept investor appetite suppressed, even as Wall Street logged record closes overnight. The Nifty 50 settled at 24,366, down 29.85 points, while the BSE Sensex declined 70.71 points to close at 78,009. For the week, the Nifty slipped 0.83 per cent lower and the BSE Sensex tumbled 0.6 per cent. **MIDCAP SLIDE**  
The Nifty Midcap 100 shed 0.53 per cent, a day after hit-

ting an all-time high of 64,125, while the Nifty Smallcap 100 fell 0.69 per cent, breaking below a six-day consolidation range. However, it was mixed trend for the broader markets during the week. While the MidCap index edged up 0.5 per cent, the SmallCap index slipped 0.7 per cent. **SECTORS SUFFER**  
Sectorally, Nifty Media and Consumer Durables were the lone gainers on Friday. Pharma, Metals, Auto, and Capital Markets bore the brunt of selling pressure. A majority of sectoral indices closed in the red for the week, with Nifty Metal slumping 1.88 per cent and Auto 1.48 per cent. Nifty Media and Consumer Durables, however, stole the limelight with 2.26

per cent gains and 1.30 per cent respectively. Among Nifty 50 stocks, Apollo Hospitals, Bharti Airtel, and Adani Enterprises led gains, while Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles, Jio Financial Services, and ONGC were the session's biggest drags during the day. Looking ahead, markets are expected to remain range-bound next week with the Q1-FY27 earnings season largely behind. "Indian equities are likely to remain range-bound next week as global cues and macro developments assume greater importance..." said Siddhartha Khemka, Head of Research at Motilal Oswal Financial Services, adding that crude, West Asia developments, and global sentiment will remain the primary near-term drivers.

When will REITs strike the right chord?

**RINGSIDE VIEW.**  
**KS BADRI NARAYANAN**

Buoyed by a slew of regulatory reforms, real estate investment trusts (REITs) have been gradually gaining popularity among investors in recent years. The market capitalisation of listed REITs has surpassed ₹2 lakh crore following the listing of Bagmane Prime REIT. Embassy Office Parks REIT was the first to enter the Indian stock market, with a ₹4,570-crore IPO in March 2019. Of late, the Union government, the Securities and Exchange Board of India and the Reserve Bank of India have rolled out several measures to boost the popularity and wider acceptance of REITs. One of the most significant initiatives was SEBI's reclassification of REITs as equity-related instruments from January 2026, followed by their inclusion in broader equity indices in July. These moves are expected to attract substantial passive inflows from mutual funds.

The RBI, meanwhile, allowed commercial banks to lend directly to REITs and Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) under a regulated prudential framework, effective October 1. However, aggregate bank exposure to any single REIT or InvIT, including its holding companies and special purpose vehicles, cannot exceed 49 per cent of the trust's asset value. **LESS TAXING**  
The recent passage of the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, is also expected to benefit REITs and InvITs. These instruments will now have greater tax flexibility and potentially lower cash tax outgo, as the amendments allow their special purpose vehicles to opt for the concessional tax regime while retaining the tax-exempt treatment of dividends distributed to unitholders. Earlier, SEBI had made sweeping changes to bring REITs within the reach of a larger pool of investors by reducing the minimum application amount from ₹50,000 to ₹10,000-15,000 and the



**POSITIVE MEASURES.** The introduction of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act in 2016 brought greater transparency to a sector long plagued by opaque transactions

trading lot size from around 200 units to just one. It also permitted the launch of Small and Medium Real Estate Investment Trusts. The introduction of the Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA) in 2016 brought greater transparency to a sector long plagued by opaque transactions, although much remains to be done on this front. SEBI is also considering allowing the issuance of depository receipts against REIT and InvIT units to widen investment options

for overseas investors and attract foreign capital. **STILL A NICHE**  
Despite these measures, REITs have yet to reach a wider investor base. Since the first REIT was listed in 2019, only six players have entered the Indian market, with Knowledge Realty and Embassy Office Parks REIT being the largest by market capitalisation. However, Colliers, a global leader in commercial real estate, engineering and investment management, painted a positive picture for

the sector. According to Colliers, an additional 370 million sq ft of existing Grade A office stock could potentially be listed as future REITs, providing a significant growth runway for the office segment. "Looking ahead, REIT penetration levels in the office market can potentially reach 30 per cent by 2030, supported by influx of high-quality green-certified assets, strong occupier demand and sustained investor appetite," it said. **A LONG ROAD AHEAD**  
It may be noted that it took nearly two decades for even advanced markets such as Singapore, the UK, Australia and Japan to popularise REITs. With only about 10 years having passed since India introduced its REIT framework — and effectively just five years since the first listing, Embassy Office Parks REIT, in 2019 — the market is still at a nascent stage. Despite the recent policy push and growing investor interest, there is a long road ahead for REITs to become a mainstream investment avenue in India.

| Nifty 50 Movers               |          |        |         |      | ▼ 29.85 pts.  |
|-------------------------------|----------|--------|---------|------|---------------|
|                               | Close(F) | Pts    | PE      | WN%  |               |
| Bharti Airtel                 | 1992.10  | 35.22  | 33.34   | 5.43 |               |
| ICICI Bank                    | 1417.00  | 15.97  | 17.01   | 9.10 |               |
| Apollo Hosp                   | 8920.50  | 7.21   | 64.05   | 0.82 |               |
| Adani Ports                   | 1700.00  | 6.77   | 29.85   | 1.12 |               |
| HDFC Bank                     | 727.00   | 6.69   | 13.57   | 9.98 |               |
| Adani Enter                   | 3035.10  | 4.43   | 52.56   | 0.79 |               |
| Bajaj Auto                    | 11700.00 | 0.94   | 28.31   | 1.16 |               |
| Eternal Ltd.                  | 318.50   | 0.79   | 709.85  | 2.07 |               |
| Wipro                         | 184.00   | 0.53   | 13.72   | 0.45 |               |
| Bharti Elec                   | 410.80   | 0.23   | 48.94   | 0.22 |               |
| M&M                           | 3428.30  | 0.02   | 21.06   | 2.71 |               |
| Sun Pharma                    | 1930.00  | -0.46  | 38.22   | 1.83 |               |
| HDFC Life                     | 535.85   | -0.52  | 58.54   | 0.52 |               |
| PowerGrid Corp                | 266.05   | -0.54  | 15.57   | 1.08 |               |
| ITC                           | 278.20   | -0.63  | 17.27   | 2.41 |               |
| Grasim Ind                    | 3248.70  | -0.68  | 21.46   | 1.10 |               |
| Titan                         | 5056.20  | -0.68  | 77.93   | 1.87 |               |
| Max Healthcare                | 1008.60  | -0.76  | 68.05   | 0.67 |               |
| Dr Reddys Lab                 | 1200.00  | -0.80  | 31.46   | 0.66 |               |
| Tech Mahindra                 | 1632.80  | -0.86  | 30.99   | 0.93 |               |
| Trent Ltd.                    | 2978.00  | -0.87  | 87.51   | 0.89 |               |
| Eicher Motors                 | 806.50   | -1.01  | 38.36   | 1.00 |               |
| SJS Steel                     | 1270.00  | -1.02  | 11.09   | 1.07 |               |
| Cipla                         | 1450.00  | -1.08  | 34.91   | 0.73 |               |
| NestleIndia                   | 1499.10  | -1.22  | 75.85   | 0.96 |               |
| TataConsumerProduct           | 1079.50  | -1.57  | 65.05   | 0.63 |               |
| SBI Life                      | 1795.00  | -1.67  | 69.23   | 0.72 |               |
| Koal India                    | 407.10   | -1.78  | 8.07    | 8.87 |               |
| Kotak Bank                    | 891.15   | -2.01  | 19.17   | 2.58 |               |
| Maruti Suzuki                 | 1394.00  | -2.02  | 30.34   | 1.62 |               |
| Bajaj Finserv                 | 2008.30  | -2.11  | 15.58   | 1.04 |               |
| Bajaj Finance                 | 1087.00  | -2.23  | 32.78   | 2.61 |               |
| UltraTech Cement              | 11619.00 | -2.25  | 39.95   | 1.23 |               |
| HCL Tech                      | 1366.00  | -2.30  | 21.17   | 1.29 |               |
| Tata Steel                    | 183.50   | -2.44  | 20.34   | 1.36 |               |
| Axis Bank                     | 1217.40  | -2.76  | 13.55   | 3.14 |               |
| Hind Unilever                 | 2077.00  | -2.91  | 46.50   | 1.65 |               |
| Int'lGlobeavi                 | 5310.00  | -2.97  | 0.00    | 1.08 |               |
| ONGC                          | 236.40   | -2.97  | 6.64    | 8.82 |               |
| TCS                           | 2361.00  | -3.12  | 17.07   | 2.16 |               |
| Shriram Finance Ltd.          | 1122.00  | -3.15  | 23.32   | 1.41 |               |
| L&T                           | 4720.00  | -4.47  | 44.39   | 2.47 |               |
| NTPC                          | 340.00   | -4.40  | 11.64   | 4.26 |               |
| Infosys                       | 1169.20  | -4.45  | 15.64   | 3.68 |               |
| Jio Financial Services Ltd.   | 249.05   | -4.70  | 79.58   | 0.73 |               |
| Hindalco                      | 1029.50  | -5.30  | 14.11   | 1.34 |               |
| Asian Paints                  | 2696.30  | -5.85  | 53.47   | 1.09 |               |
| Tata Motors PV                | 334.50   | -6.30  | 4106.36 | 0.63 |               |
| Reliance Ind                  | 1310.00  | -10.33 | 20.11   | 7.94 |               |
| State Bank                    | 1067.70  | -13.82 | 10.99   | 3.96 |               |
| Pts: Impact on index movement |          |        |         |      |               |
| Nifty Next 50 Movers          |          |        |         |      | ▼ 240.10 pts. |
|                               | Close(F) | Pts    | PE      | WN%  |               |
| HindustanAeronautics          | 5029.90  | 46.81  | 36.90   | 3.72 |               |
| Cummins India                 | 5400.00  | 33.37  | 63.24   | 2.85 |               |
| Adani Energy Solutions        | 1616.00  | 31.49  | 62.82   | 2.07 |               |
| AdaniGreenenergy              | 1348.00  | 28.35  | 103.47  | 1.76 |               |
| Bpcl                          | 319.45   | 26.21  | 8.09    | 2.53 |               |
| United Spirits                | 1536.00  | 18.03  | 66.22   | 1.77 |               |
| SamvardhaneInternatl          | 168.30   | 11.55  | 39.00   | 2.90 |               |
| Macrotech Developers          | 1243.90  | 9.35   | 30.10   | 1.35 |               |
| Bosch                         | 47100.00 | 8.82   | 58.78   | 1.59 |               |
| Cg Power & Ind Sol            | 880.15   | 7.17   | 113.23  | 2.38 |               |
| Union Bank                    | 187.38   | 4.94   | 6.4     | 1.43 |               |
| Punjab Natl Bank              | 118.00   | 4.10   | 6.13    | 1.59 |               |
| MazdaGoan Dock                | 2580.00  | 1.99   | 36.47   | 0.76 |               |
| DIF                           | 665.00   | 1.86   | 37.02   | 1.66 |               |
| Bank Of Baroda                | 248.22   | 1.19   | 6.98    | 1.80 |               |
| Tata Capital                  | 364.20   | 0.86   | 28.22   | 0.72 |               |
| PfizerInd                     | 1693.00  | -2.79  | 64.39   | 2.04 |               |
| Tata Motors Cv                | 474.30   | -3.03  | 57.68   | 3.86 |               |
| Godrej Consumer               | 934.30   | -3.04  | 49.96   | 1.46 |               |
| Bajaj Holdings                | 11475.00 | -3.15  | 14.20   | 1.94 |               |
| Ambuja Cements                | 417.50   | -3.44  | 20.00   | 1.02 |               |
| Tata Power                    | 382.05   | -3.64  | 23.23   | 2.49 |               |
| Indian Hotels Co.             | 4720.00  | -4.47  | 44.39   | 2.47 |               |
| Indian Railway Finance Corp   | 87.57    | -4.56  | 15.92   | 0.69 |               |
| Avenuesuper                   | 4060.00  | -4.68  | 86.61   | 2.55 |               |
| Canara Bank                   | 131.25   | -5.37  | 6.00    | 1.72 |               |
| Siemens Energy India          | 3536.30  | -6.40  | 84.63   | 1.22 |               |
| Gail (India)                  | 174.90   | -7.84  | 11.65   | 1.84 |               |
| DVLS Lab                      | 8477.00  | -8.49  | 76.94   | 2.40 |               |
| Hdfc Amc                      | 2485.00  | -8.59  | 36.14   | 1.98 |               |
| Jindal Steel                  | 1091.50  | -9.04  | 41.11   | 1.58 |               |
| Abb India                     | 7649.00  | -9.30  | 104.23  | 1.57 |               |
| Adani Power                   | 205.25   | -10.25 | 27.24   | 3.32 |               |
| MuthootFin                    | 2842.00  | -10.50 | 9.96    | 1.19 |               |
| Siemens                       | 3940.00  | -12.07 | 96.58   | 1.36 |               |
| Power Finance                 | 376.00   | -12.68 | 10.51   | 2.03 |               |
| Lotimindree                   | 471.50   | -13.49 | 26.91   | 1.71 |               |
| Hyundai Motor India           | 2199.00  | -15.79 | 36.09   | 1.22 |               |
| Shree Cement                  | 24795.00 | -17.49 | 54.68   | 1.29 |               |
| Vedanta                       | 267.50   | -17.74 | 6.27    | 1.77 |               |
| Britannia Ind                 | 5558.00  | -19.51 | 51.29   | 2.55 |               |
| Vision Beverages              | 435.00   | -21.85 | 43.16   | 2.32 |               |
| Indian Oilcorp                | 139.40   | -22.80 | 5.51    | 2.03 |               |
| Hindus Zinc                   | 561.90   | -22.99 | 13.91   | 1.05 |               |
| Zyduslifesciences             | 1135.20  | -23.34 | 24.87   | 1.11 |               |
| Tvs Motor Cmp.                | 4307.00  | -24.03 | 56.82   | 1.95 |               |
| Asian Industries              | 19969.00 | -25.13 | 104.05  | 1.90 |               |
| Torrent Pharma                | 4833.00  | -34.74 | 85.27   | 2.73 |               |
| Relax Elec                    | 355.00   | -41.74 | 5.50    | 1.63 |               |
| CholamandaminiFin             | 1894.40  | -42.12 | 28.08   | 3.20 |               |
| Pts: Impact on index movement |          |        |         |      |               |



QUICKLY.

Juniper to invest ₹850 cr to build luxury hotel

**Mumbai:** Juniper Hotels plans to invest ₹850 crore to develop a 5-star luxury hotel in Delhi, adding about 550 keys. Upon completion, Juniper's presence in New Delhi is expected to expand to about 1,000 keys. The hotel is targeted for completion by 2030. The company executed a licence deed with the Delhi Development Authority, through its wholly-owned subsidiary, Juniper Hospitality Assets. The hotel will enjoy a prime location overlooking the DDA Dwarka Golf Course and in proximity to Yashobhoomi Convention Centre, as well as the Dwarka Sports Complex. The unique setting is expected to enhance the property's appeal to premium leisure and business travellers seeking premium hospitality experiences. **OUR BUREAU**

PNB in GYFTR deal to spur credit card engagement

**Mumbai:** Punjab National Bank (PNB) has signed a three-year agreement with digital engagement platform GYFTR Ltd to build a dedicated rewards and offers channel for its credit card customers, the companies announced. Under the deal, GYFTR will design, build and operate a white-label digital platform featuring PNB's branding, through which eligible credit card holders can access curated offers from participating consumer brands. **OUR BUREAU**

Ministry lifts ad duration cap for TV channels to ensure level playing field

**Meenakshi Verma Ambwani**  
New Delhi

In relief for the broadcasting industry, the Information & Broadcasting Ministry on Friday said that it has decided to remove the 12-minute advertisement duration cap for television channels.

The Ministry said the decision was taken to enable fair competition and ensure ease of doing business. This marks a key shift in the regulatory framework that governs broadcast advertising.

"In India, the sector is heavily dependent on advertising, irrespective of whether a channel is pay or free-to-air. Furthermore, there was a non-level playing field for traditional TV channels *vis-a-vis* digital media, where no such stipulation on advertisement cap regulation exists. The Ministry of I&B is of the view that there exists adequate competition in the market within the TV industry and between the TV industry and digital media. The Government has decided to remove the advertisement duration cap to enable fair competition and ensure ease of doing business," the Ministry said.



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India heading for historic solar installation numbers this year

**AMBITIOUS PUSH.** It plans to add a record 50 gigawatts capacity, driven by the government's ALMM mandate

**Rishi Ranjan Kala**  
New Delhi

India is on course to add a record 50 gigawatts (GW) of solar power capacity in the 2026 calendar year, largely aided by the ALMM mandate for solar PV cells and the phased removal of waivers for inter-state transmission charges.

The country is set to commission more solar capacity in 2026 than in any year in its installation history, even as the policy driving that surge simultaneously creates a supply crunch that will push system prices significantly higher, research and consultancy firm Wood Mackenzie said.

"India added 34 GWdc (gigawatts-direct current) of solar capacity in H1 2026, 38 per cent above H1 2025 levels, as developers raced to commission projects ahead of the June deadline for the approved list of models and manufacturers-II (ALMM-II). Full-year additions are forecast to exceed 50 GWdc, surpassing the previous record of 49 GWdc set in 2025," it added.

Sureet Singh, Research Analyst at Wood Mackenzie, noted that India's ALMM-II mandate is a bold step towards building a fully-integrated domestic solar supply



**TARIFF ADJUSTMENT.** The accelerated build-out was driven by the phased removal of waivers for transmission charges

chain, but cell manufacturing capacity has simply not kept pace with modules.

The near-term cost impact is unavoidable, and developers will need to navigate a difficult transition period before prices stabilise.

**CONCENTRATED PUSH**

The 34 GWdc added in H1 2026 reflects a concentrated push by developers to complete projects before ALMM-II took effect, requiring the use of modules produced from domestically manufactured cells in government-supported projects.

The accelerated build-out was further driven by the phased removal of waivers for inter-state transmission charges, which fell from 75 per cent to 50 per cent for projects commissioned from

July 2026 onwards and are set to be phased out entirely after July 2028.

Momentum is expected to slow in H2 2026 as cell capacity constraints and rising module prices weigh on project development.

However, ALMM-II waivers granted for net metering and open access projects until December 31, 2026 could provide upside to that figure.

The Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE) also agreed in July 2026 to waive the mandate for projects approaching completion, requiring applicants to have submitted applications by 23 July 2026.

**IMPORT DEPENDENCY**

Wood Mackenzie pointed out that ALMM-II has reduced India's direct cell im-

ports from China. However, sourcing has pivoted toward Southeast Asia, with Indonesian cell imports nearly tripling in early 2026.

In the first five months of 2026, India imported 5 GW of wafers and 20 GW of cells, with wafer imports climbing 86 per cent year-on-year to support domestic cell production, it pointed out.

**CUSTOMS DUTY**

India has imposed a 20 per cent basic customs duty on imported cells and modules, and in September 2025 the DGTR recommended additional anti-dumping duties of up to 30 per cent on Chinese-origin solar cells and modules, pending a final decision from the Central government, making Indonesian-origin supply an increasingly attractive alternative, though circumvention scrutiny may follow given the pattern of Chinese cell re-routing observed in other markets, Wood Mackenzie said.

"Any delay to the 14 GW of new cell manufacturing capacity currently under construction risks deepening import reliance and driving prices beyond current estimates. 130 GW of additional cell capacity is expected to come online by 2029, requiring a compound annual growth rate of 49 per cent

from the 2026 full-build baseline of 88 GW," it added.

**ELEVATED PRICES**

Even as new cell capacity comes online, Wood Mackenzie expects insufficient utilisation to keep supply short of demand in 2027.

"Cell production is projected to reach 29 GW next year, still falling 21 GW short of the average annual module demand of 50 GW. As a result, system prices are forecast to decline by just 3 per cent between Q4 2026 and Q4 2027," it anticipated.

Mathew Thomas, Researcher at Wood Mackenzie, said that prices are expected to stabilise through 2029 as additional cell capacity comes online, but the transition will require policy consistency and timely execution by manufacturers.

"The rollout of ALMM-II (solar cells) may follow ALMM-I's (Solar modules) pattern of multiple exemptions, though the impact should be more contained given greater preparedness among suppliers, developers and policymakers," he added.

The MNRE's plan to implement ALMM-III in June 2028, extending the mandate to solar wafers, signals that India's domestic content ambitions are far from complete, Thomas said.

Just In Time aiming for major expansion, eyes ₹1,000 cr revenue mark

**Meenakshi Verma Ambwani**  
New Delhi



Multi-brand watch retailer Just In Time, which recently hit the 100<sup>th</sup> store milestone, is aiming to ramp up its retail footprint as it is eyeing revenues of ₹1,000 crore by FY27-end.

The company, which has been focusing on the top 20 cities, said it is looking at widening its retail footprint in newer markets while continuing to deepen presence in existing cities.

Ronak Shah, CEO, Just In Time, told *businessline*, "We have been focused on company-owned and company-operated model, which gives us a big leverage in offering the best customer experience. Opening the 100th store has been a key milestone for us. We are now looking at doubling down on our retail footprint and we plan to add another 100 stores." He added that the company had been adding 35-45 stores annually.

Currently, the company has a strong presence in about 20 top cities. "We are looking at entering untapped cities and States and believe 200 stores-mark will give us a significant presence across the country," he added.

The expansion comes at a time when discretionary spends on segments such as watches have continued to be resilient in recent times

unlike some other categories.

"We have been growing our revenues at 35-38 per cent annually, which is ahead of industry growth rate. We aim to touch ₹1,000 crore revenue mark by FY 27-end. Even looking at July growth trends, we believe we are on track to achieve our targets," Shah noted.

**DEMAND TRENDS**

Talking about the demand trends, Shah said, the company has built a strong presence in the 'bridge to premium' segment. "We believe the 'bridge to premium' segment will continue to see strong demand amidst rising consumer aspirations. In terms of price point matrix it is between ₹10,000 to ₹2 lakh and we believe that is the sweet spot," he added.

Responding to a query on IPO plans, Shah said, "It is definitely on the cards but we do not have a finalised timeline yet. But we are working on making the organisation more efficient to be ready for the public markets."



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Sd/- Asst. General Manager (Materials)



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**COCHIN SHIPYARD LIMITED**

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CIN:L63032KL1972GOI002414

**UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026**

The unaudited standalone and consolidated financial results of Cochin Shipyard Limited ("the Company") along with the Limited Review Reports of the Statutory Auditors of the Company for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 was approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at its Meeting held on August 14, 2026, in terms of Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

The aforementioned financial results, along with the Limited Review Reports of the Statutory Auditors thereon, are available in the Company's website ([https://cochinshipyard.in/investor/investor\\_titles/54](https://cochinshipyard.in/investor/investor_titles/54)) and in the websites of the National Stock Exchange of India Limited ([www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com)) and BSE Limited ([www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com)). The same can also be accessed by scanning the QR code given below:



Scan the QR code to view the results on the website of the Company

**For Cochin Shipyard Limited**  
Sd/-  
**Kochi August 14, 2026**  
**Director (Finance) & Chairman & Managing Director**

The Hindi version of this advertisement is published on the website ([www.cochinshipyard.in](http://www.cochinshipyard.in)) of CSL.



**NATCO Pharma Limited**  
Regd. Office: Natco House, Road No.2, Banjara Hills, Hyderabad-500 034, Phone: 040-23547532, Email: [investors@natcopharma.co.in](mailto:investors@natcopharma.co.in) CIN: L24230TG1981PLC003201, [www.natcopharma.co.in](http://www.natcopharma.co.in)

**STATEMENT OF UN-AUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026**

Based on the recommendations of the Audit Committee, the Board of Directors of the Company at their meeting held on August 14, 2026, have approved the Un-audited standalone and consolidated financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026.

The abovementioned financial results along with press release thereon are available on Company's website at [https://admin.natcopharma.co.in/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/BMOutcome\\_14082026.pdf](https://admin.natcopharma.co.in/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/BMOutcome_14082026.pdf) and also at [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com) and [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com)

Scan the Quick Response (QR) code access the Q1FY27 Results



**for NATCO PHARMA LIMITED**  
Sd/-  
**Place: Hyderabad August 14, 2026**  
**V C Nannapaneni**  
Chairman & Managing Director



**RAJAPALAYAM MILLS LIMITED**  
Regd. Office : Rajapalayam Mills Premises  
P.A.C. Ramasamy Raja Salai, Post Box No.1, Rajapalayam - 626 117, Tamil Nadu.  
CIN : L17111TN1936PLC002298 Telephone: 04563 – 235666, Fax: 04563 - 236520  
Email: [rajacot@ramcotex.com](mailto:rajacot@ramcotex.com) Website: <http://www.rajapalayammills.co.in>

**SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALIZATION OF PHYSICAL SHARES**  
Pursuant to SEBI circular SEBI/HO/38/13/11(2)(2026-MRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders are informed that, a special window is opened only for transfer and dematerialisation of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to 1<sup>st</sup> April, 2019.

The special window shall be open for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027. Shareholders are requested to lodge transfer deed executed prior to April 01, 2019 along with original security certificate(s) and other documents as specified in the aforementioned SEBI circular with the Company latest by 4<sup>th</sup> February, 2027 at the below mentioned address:

**The Company Secretary, Rajapalayam Mills Limited, Rajapalayam Mills Premises, P.A.C. Ramasamy Raja Salai, Post Box No.1, Rajapalayam - 626 117**

PLACE: RAJAPALAYAM For RAJAPALAYAM MILLS LIMITED  
DATE: 14-08-2026 K. MAHESWARAN, SECRETARY



**KSE LIMITED**  
CIN No: L15331KL1963PLC002028  
Regd. Office: Post Box No. 20, Solvent Road, Irinjalakuda, Kerala - 680 121  
Ph: 0480 - 2825476, E-mail: [ksekerala@gmail.com](mailto:ksekerala@gmail.com), Web: [www.kselimited.com](http://www.kselimited.com)

**EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30<sup>TH</sup> JUNE, 2026**  
(Rs. in Lakhs)

| Particulars                                                                                                                                  | Quarter ended        |                    |                      | Year ended         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
|                                                                                                                                              | 30.06.2026 Unaudited | 31.03.2026 Audited | 30.06.2025 Unaudited | 31.03.2026 Audited |
| Total Income from Operations                                                                                                                 | 45722.63             | 41253.90           | 42053.34             | 169575.05          |
| Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extra-ordinary Items)                                                     | 82.68                | (468.70)           | 5196.41              | 11406.83           |
| Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extra-ordinary Items)                                                | 129.85               | (468.70)           | 5196.41              | 11406.83           |
| Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extra ordinary items)                                                 | 94.43                | (373.42)           | 3855.43              | 8404.03            |
| Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)] | 42.41                | (222.79)           | 3773.02              | 8475.37            |
| Paid up Equity Share Capital                                                                                                                 | 320.00               | 320.00             | 320.00               | 320.00             |
| Other Equity                                                                                                                                 |                      |                    |                      | 34630.02           |
| Earnings Per Equity Share of Rs.1 each (for continuing and discontinued operations) (not annualised)                                         |                      |                    |                      |                    |
| Basic (Rs.)                                                                                                                                  | 0.295                | (1.167)            | 12.048               | 26.263             |
| Diluted (Rs.)                                                                                                                                | 0.295                | (1.167)            | 12.048               | 26.263             |

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Financial Results for the quarter ended 30<sup>th</sup> June, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results for the quarter ended 30<sup>th</sup> June, 2026 are available on the Stock Exchange website at [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com) and on the Company's website at [www.kselimited.com](http://www.kselimited.com).



**For KSE Limited**  
Sd/-  
**Dony A.G.**  
(DIN 09211623)  
Managing Director

Irinjalakuda  
14<sup>th</sup> August 2026

**AVT NATURAL PRODUCTS LIMITED**  
Regd. Office : 60, Rukmani Lakshmiipathy Salai, Egmore, Chennai – 600 008. Tele.fax: (+91) 44 28584147, Email : [avtnpl@avtnatural.com](mailto:avtnpl@avtnatural.com), Website : [www.avtnatural.com](http://www.avtnatural.com); CIN : L15142TN1986PLC012780.

**EXTRACT FROM THE UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30<sup>TH</sup> JUNE, 2026**  
(Rs. In Lakhs, Except EPS)

| Sl. No | Particulars                                                                                                                        | Standalone           |                    | Consolidated         |                    |                      |                    |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|----------------------|--------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
|        |                                                                                                                                    | Quarter Ended        |                    | Quarter Ended        |                    | Year Ended           |                    |
|        |                                                                                                                                    | 30.06.2026 Unaudited | 31.03.2026 Audited | 30.06.2025 Unaudited | 31.03.2026 Audited | 30.06.2025 Unaudited | 31.03.2026 Audited |
| 1      | Total income from operations                                                                                                       | 23,081.04            | 21,641.62          | 12,491.05            | 68,377.05          | 24,121.46            | 22,648.97          |
| 2      | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extra Ordinary items)                                         | 3,161.92             | 2,574.75           | 1,175.22             | 6,918.45           | 3,904.89             | 3,040.75           |
| 3      | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax, (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary Items)                                    | 3,161.92             | 2,574.75           | 1,175.22             | 6,918.45           | 3,904.89             | 3,040.75           |
| 4      | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax, (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary Items)                                     | 2,386.65             | 1,928.87           | 935.62               | 5,385.15           | 3,110.05             | 2,202.14           |
| 5      | Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax) | 2,642.97             | 1,685.63           | 988.65               | 4,976.76           | 3,293.91             | 2,270.17           |
| 6      | Equity Share Capital                                                                                                               | 1,522.84             | 1,522.84           | 1,522.84             | 1,522.84           | 1,522.84             | 1,522.84           |
| 7      | Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the Previous Year                                | -                    | -                  | -                    | 52,213.55          | -                    | -                  |
| 8      | Earnings per share (face value of Re.1/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) (not annualized)                       |                      |                    |                      |                    |                      |                    |
|        | a) Basic :                                                                                                                         | 1.57                 | 1.27               | 0.61                 | 3.54               | 2.04                 | 1.45               |
|        | b) Diluted :                                                                                                                       | 1.57                 | 1.27               | 0.61                 | 3.54               | 2.04                 | 1.45               |

Note:  
1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange (BSE: [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com) and NSE: [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com)) and also on the website of the Company, [www.avtnatural.com](http://www.avtnatural.com)



**AVT NATURAL PRODUCTS LIMITED**  
Place : Chennai  
Date : 14.08.2026

**AJIT THOMAS**  
CHAIRMAN



QUICKLY.

Airtel Money mulls  
UK listing in dollars



Airtel Africa Plc is considering having its mobile payments arm trade in US dollars when it lists it in London later this year, an arrangement that's only been seen a handful of times. The group is evaluating listing Airtel Money's shares in US dollars rather than British pounds to match its reporting currency, according to people familiar with this. More banks have been invited to work on the deal, including ones based in Africa and the Middle East, they said, asking not to be identified because the deliberations are private. The operator last month confirmed plans to list its Airtel Money unit on the London Stock Exchange, which could fetch a valuation of up to \$10 billion, Bloomberg reported previously. BLOOMBERG

# US may step up economic pressure on Iran amid fresh ship attacks in Hormuz

**TOUGH STANCE.** Washington warns of isolation, naval presence in the region to enforce retaliatory blockade

Reuters  
London/Panama City

Transit through the Strait of Hormuz appeared to grind to a near standstill on Friday after two more ships were attacked there and the US said it could maintain a naval blockade of Iran indefinitely. A senior Iranian source said on Wednesday that there had been no progress in talks to build on a June agreement to end the war. As a ceasefire renewed then broke down, Iran has resumed attacks on ships it accuses of trying to transit the Strait without its permission. Two vessels from the state-owned Abu Dhabi National Oil Company were attacked transiting the strait on Thursday evening, UAE state news agency WAM reported. The United Arab Emirates government



**SUBDUED MOVEMENT.** Nine vessels passed through the narrow waterway at the entrance to the Gulf on Thursday

blamed Iran, which made no immediate comment. Nine vessels passed through the narrow waterway at the entrance to the Gulf on Thursday, up from five on Wednesday but below the average for August of 12, according to ship-tracking company Kpler. There were no visible crossings by vessels seen early on Friday, according to ship-tracking data. Some ships may pass through undetected with

their transponders off, but the figures are nowhere near the more than 130 ships that daily traversed the Strait of Hormuz before the war launched by the US and Israel on Iran in February. **THREAT TO INFRA** “Alongside the threat to energy infrastructure in the region, Iran’s ability to restrict shipping through the Strait is its main source of leverage in negotiations,” said Torbjorn Solvedt, principal

Middle East analyst with risk intelligence company Verisk Maplecroft. US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth told reporters the US military has the capability to maintain a naval presence in the region to enforce its retaliatory blockade of Iran, which has inflicted severe economic damage on the country. “Indefinitely the United States Navy can maintain a blockade like that because we’ll rotate ships in and out, as we have, and we’ll continue to,” Hegseth told reporters during a trip to Panama. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the United States planned to inflict more financial damage on Iran. “Watch this space for more announcements coming next week because we are going to apply measures like have never been seen in the history of economic isola-

tion on a country,” he said in an interview. US President Donald Trump is under pressure at home to end an unpopular war, with high fuel prices dragging down his approval ratings and potentially eroding his party’s control of Congress in mid-term elections in November. Benchmark Brent futures and US West Texas Intermediate crude futures were both up slightly at about \$87 and \$81 a barrel respectively. India’s reliance on Russian crude surged to a record in July, while refineries in Asia, a major customer for fuel from the Gulf, bought US crude this week to ensure future supplies. Trump has repeatedly asserted that the US has “total control” over the Strait, through which a fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas flowed before the start of the war, prompting Iranian denials.

# Indonesia announces new commodity bourse

Reuters  
Jakarta



Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto delivering his annual budget speech in Parliament

Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto announced a plan on Friday to create a new exchange that will set prices for the country’s strategic commodities by the start of next year, in a fresh gambit to leverage the country’s vast natural resources to boost growth. Since taking office in 2024, Prabowo has pushed policies that expand state influence over critical minerals in the resource-rich nation, a major global supplier of palm oil, nickel products and thermal coal, as well as copper, bauxite and natural gas. The announcement, made during Prabowo’s speech on his 2027 budget proposal, followed remarks to reassure the markets over the role of a new state export firm, Danantara Sumberdaya Indonesia, which will monitor key commodity shipments, but would not take control of exports. “If they don’t want to pay the prices we set, then don’t buy them,” Prabowo said in a fiery speech in Parliament. “Better to keep those commodities, nickel, tin, gold in the ground for our children, grandchildren,” he added. “Our coal, our gas, our oil... let them remain in the ground. We drink the coffee ourselves.” The exchange for strategic minerals and commodities is expected to be operational by January 1, 2027 to develop reference prices for Indonesia’s main commodity exports, Prabowo said. Rules for the new bourse

will be introduced by September 17, the Chief of Indonesia’s Financial Services Authority, which will oversees the commodity exchange, Friderica Widayarsi Dewi, told journalists later. **MORE REVENUE** Prabowo used his Independence Day speeches to highlight his plan to secure more revenue from Indonesia’s natural resources, at a time when his approval rating is falling and there is growing investor scepticism over his ambitious policies and plans to control commodity exports. “Indonesia must not forever remain a country where commodities are extracted while their prices and profits are determined elsewhere,” he said. “We do not merely want to be a global producer of commodities; we must become a price-setter.” Prabowo did not elaborate which commodities will be included in the new bourse. “We do not want the Indonesian people to be cheated any more,” he told Parliament on Friday.

# ‘Demand destruction cushions impact of geopolitical oil spikes’

Richa Mishra  
Hyderabad

Global crude prices have defied expectations by remaining remarkably stable during the largest oil supply shock in decades, thanks to four critical market buffers. According to Kelly Xu, a Commodity & Energy Strategist at Alpine Macro, a catastrophic price surge was averted through massive demand destruction, non-Gulf supply growth, alternative export routes and strategic inventory management. Speaking to *businessline*, Xu explained that these mechanisms successfully re-balanced the global energy market and cushioned major import-dependent economies like India. Supply growth outside the Gulf has provided an additional cushion, she said. Higher output from non-OPEC+ producers — projec-

ted to grow by about 0.6 mb/d in 2026, led by gains in Brazil, the US, Canada, and Argentina — has partially offset lost volumes from Gulf producers. **MARKET IMPACT** According to Xu, alternative export routes and greater shipping flexibility have reduced the market impact of disruptions through the Strait of Hormuz. Key measures include pipeline systems that bypass the Strait, as well as shipping arrangements such as ship-to-ship transfers in the Gulf of Oman. Finally, inventories have provided another source of market flexibility. “Strategic stock releases from the US and other OECD countries have injected a significant volume of barrels into the market, helping bridge the supply gap during the disruption,” she said. On being asked how much



fiscal headroom global adjustment mechanisms granted the Indian government to manage inflation and subsidies, she replied: “First, the current supply shock hasn’t moved crude prices to an extreme. While India’s 90 per cent import dependence historically leaves it vulnerable to market disruptions, the transmission of this shock to domestic inflation has so far been relatively contained.” “Gradual domestic fuel price adjustments have shielded India’s headline in-

flation from global crude shocks. Regulated gasoline costs rose modestly from mid-May, peaking in late June below early-2025 levels before decreasing. This limited pass-through successfully cushioned the economy from international price surges,” she said. **LIMITING PRESSURE** The oil shock has not triggered broad-based inflation, she said, noting that the government’s response focused on containing inflation while limiting pressure on public finances. Instead of using broad-based fuel subsidies like in previous shocks, India combined fuel tax adjustments, measured retail price changes, targeted support, and strict subsidy cost management. These measures shielded consumers from sharp energy cost increases but involved fiscal trade-offs, she cautioned. “Reduced fuel

taxes lowered revenue, while higher subsidies and support for state oil companies increased expenditure. While the lack of an extreme oil spike provided fiscal headroom, prolonged conflict risks could gradually erode this flexibility. A muted global crude increase limits India’s import bill, reduces inflation pressures and lowers the need for costly government interventions. However, high uncertainty remains regarding the duration of regional conflicts, threatening long-term fiscal stability,” she said. **SUPPLY DISRUPTIONS** When asked if Indian refiners are losing their leverage to demand deep discounts on Russian oil, she explained: “India’s bargaining power is driven less by absolute global crude prices and more by Russian supply availability, competing buyers, sanctions and India’s al-

ternative options.” “While Middle East supply disruptions increase the strategic value of Russian crude, Indian refiners have not lost their leverage. The initial, exceptionally large discounts have narrowed as Russia adapted its logistics and export channels away from Europe. However, because India remains a primary buyer and sanctions still limit Russia’s market access, refiners retain negotiating power. Additionally, temporary US sanctions waivers during the early stages of the Iran conflict maintained global supply flows but left broader constraints intact,” she added. “Finally, a sharp decline in China’s global crude imports reduces competition for Russian barrels. As Russia’s other major buyer pulls back, its dependence on Indian demand increases, further preserving India’s leverage,” she said.

# China’s Z.ai says GLM-5.3 nears Anthropic’s Mythos 5 in cyber-defence tests

Reuters  
Beijing

Chinese AI startup Z.ai said on Friday its open-source GLM-5.3 model had neared Anthropic’s restricted Mythos 5 in identifying software vulnerabilities, bolstering the credentials of a Chinese AI challenger gaining traction among Western developers. Z.ai said GLM-5.3 scored 84.5 per cent on CyberGym, a test of whether a model can review code, identify security flaws and confirm that they are real. That was slightly higher than the 83.8 per cent it reported for Mythos 5. The results have not been independently verified. GLM-5.3 lagged behind Mythos 5 in converting discovered flaws into working attacks, a standard part of defensive security research. Z.ai said its model scored 54.4 per cent on the Exploit Bench test of this capability, versus 78 per cent for Mythos 5. In a separate timed test, Z.ai said GLM-5.3 completed 105 attack-development tasks in two hours and 130 in six hours. Mythos 5 completed 181 and 247 tasks, respectively. Anthropic has made Mythos, a version of its Claude Fable 5 model with cybersecurity safeguards removed, available only to vetted organisations. Such controls reflect concern that AI systems capable of finding and exploiting software flaws can assist defenders but may also lower barriers for attackers.

**SECURITY ASSESSMENTS** Z.ai said it would release GLM-5.3 publicly in about two weeks after completing security assessments and strengthening its safeguards. Its most sensitive cybersecurity functions would be available only to verified users through a “trusted access” programme, it said. It wrote in a Friday X post that initial model access will be shared with a select group of launch partners, which will later be expanded “through a consistent and responsible process”, echoing the language of Anthropic’s “Project Glasswing” limited-access scheme for Mythos. “To the best of my knowledge, this is the first time a Chinese lab is publicly justifying a delayed open release of model weights with safety considerations,” said Gabriel Wagner, an AI governance researcher at Concordia AI, a Beijing-based consultancy focused on AI safety. “This shows that open-weight risk management practices in China are becoming more sophisticated.” The firm said it had added layers of protection to GLM-5.3 to distinguish harmful activity from legitimate uses such as fixing bugs, teaching cybersecurity or authorised security testing.

# AI emerges as revenue pool, but not yet growth engine

Sanjana B  
Bengaluru

Indian IT services firms are increasingly quantifying their AI businesses, as investor pressure pushes companies to demonstrate that the technology is translating into a commercial revenue stream. However, analysts caution that AI is yet to emerge as a broad-based growth engine, with inconsistent revenue definitions and heavy investments in talent and technology limiting its near-term margin benefits. HCLTech reported advanced AI revenue of \$171 million in Q1FY27, up 10.6 per cent quarter-on-quarter in constant currency (cc) and 62.1 per cent y-o-y in constant currency. TCS reported annualised AI revenue of \$2.6 billion in Q1FY27, up 13.6 per cent sequentially, while Infosys said AI accounted for 8.2 per cent of its revenue during the quarter. **AI PRODUCTIVITY** Beyond revenue, AI and GenAI are improving IT service delivery efficiency by automating routine tasks, enabling faster project cycles and improving real-time decision-



Overall revenue growth during the quarter remained mixed, pointing to the need for discretionary spending

making. Proof-of-value sprints and AI monitoring centres have also delivered measurable productivity gains in some cases, DD Mishra, VP Analyst at Gartner, said. Specialised AI deployments, like domain-specific SLMs, have shown greater ROI due to lower operational costs compared to generalised LLMs. Mishra said despite efficiency gains, the disclosures indicate margin benefits due to AI are partially offset by substantial investments in talent and technology infrastructure.

With the rapid scaling of AI capabilities, firms are investing heavily in training and upskilling their workforce to manage and advance AI projects. The net result is a juxtaposition: While AI deployments improve operational efficiency and support incremental revenue growth, the benefits to margins are partially neutralised by the need for ongoing, heavy capital and talent investments to sustain and scale these capabilities. **MIXED REVENUE** Analysts noted that while public Q1FY27 disclosures are meaningful at the provider level, they are not enough to conclude that AI is driving broad sector acceleration, because overall revenue growth during the quarter remained mixed; discretionary spending is cautious. The better interpretation is that AI is becoming a measurable revenue pool, not yet a sector-wide growth engine.



## Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter Ended June 30, 2026

The Unaudited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results of Jinkushal Industries Limited (“the Company”) along with the Limited Review Report of the Statutory Auditors of the Company for the quarter ended on June 30, 2026 have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their Meeting held on August 14, 2026, in terms of Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

The results along with the Limited Review Report have been posted on the Company’s website at <https://www.jkipl.in/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/JKIPL-FINANCIAL-RESULT-JUNE-2026.pdf> and on stock exchanges website [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com) and [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com), respectively. The results can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code.

**Place:** Raipur  
**Date:** August 14, 2026

**Note:** The above information is in accordance with Regulation 33 read with Regulation 47(i) of SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015.

For and on behalf of the  
Board of Directors of  
Jinkushal Industries Limited

**Mr. Anil Kumar Jain**  
Chairman & Director  
**DIN: 00679518**



ASIRVAD MICRO FINANCE LIMITED  
Subsidiary of MANAPPURAM FINANCE LTD.  
Small Loans...Big Dreams...

In the matter of

### ASIRVAD MICRO FINANCE LIMITED

Having its registered office at  
CEEBOOS MANJULA, 3rd Floor, Office No. 1, New No. 39, Old No. 45, Montieth Road, Egmore, Opp: Indian Red Cross Society, Chennai, Tamil Nadu-600008

**Form No. INC-26**  
[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]  
Advertisement published for change of Registered Office of the Company from one state to another.

Before the Central Government, Southern Region  
In the matter of sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Companies Act, 2013 and clause (a) of sub-rule (5) of rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the company proposes to make application to the Central Government under section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Annual General Meeting of the Company held on August 10, 2026 to enable the company to change its Registered Office from “State of Tamil Nadu” to “State of Kerala”.

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the company may deliver **either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing investor complaint form** or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director at the address **5th Floor, Shastri Bhavan, Haddows Road, Nungambakam, Chennai-600006** within fourteen days of the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its registered office at the address mentioned below:

CEEBOOS MANJULA, 3rd Floor, Office No. 1, New No. 39, Old No. 45, Montieth Road, Egmore, Opp: Indian Red Cross Society, Chennai, Tamil Nadu - 600008

For and on behalf of Asirvad Micro Finance Limited.

Sd/-  
V.P. Nandakumar  
DIN: 00044512  
Chairman

Date : August 15, 2026  
Place : Chennai

| Sakthi Finance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |               |            |             |            |  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------|-------------|------------|--|
| SAKTHI FINANCE LIMITED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |               |            |             |            |  |
| (CIN : L65910TZ1955PLC000145)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |               |            |             |            |  |
| Regd. Office : 62, Dr. Nanjappa Road, Coimbatore - 641 018                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |               |            |             |            |  |
| Ph : (0422) 4236200 E-mail : investors@sakthifinance.com                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |               |            |             |            |  |
| Website: www.sakthifinance.com                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |               |            |             |            |  |
| Extract of Statement of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30 June 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |               |            |             |            |  |
| Particulars                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Quarter Ended |            |             | Year Ended |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 30.06.2026    | 31.03.2026 | 30.06.2025  | 31.03.2026 |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | (Unaudited)   | (Audited)  | (Unaudited) | (Audited)  |  |
| Total Revenue from Operations (net)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5,099.88      | 4,927.89   | 5,374.56    | 21,070.54  |  |
| Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and Exceptional Items)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 553.21        | 667.93     | 580.66      | 2,340.06   |  |
| Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional Items)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 553.21        | 667.93     | 580.66      | 2,340.06   |  |
| Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional Items)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 418.36        | 561.77     | 411.92      | 1,724.90   |  |
| Other Comprehensive Income (net of tax)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 13.36         | (14.58)    | 24.72       | (24.49)    |  |
| Total Comprehensive Income for the period (comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (net of tax))                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 431.72        | 547.19     | 436.64      | 1,700.41   |  |
| Paid-up equity share capital (Face value : ₹ 10 per share)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 6,470.59      | 6,470.59   | 6,470.59    | 6,470.59   |  |
| Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | -             | -          | -           | 15,324.92  |  |
| Securities Premium                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 1,429.80      | 1,429.80   | 1,429.80    | 1,429.80   |  |
| Net worth                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 20,899.09     | 20,477.89  | 20,420.78   | 20,477.89  |  |
| Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 0.59          | 0.60       | 0.53        | 0.60       |  |
| Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NA            | NA         | NA          | NA         |  |
| Debt Equity Ratio                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 5.24          | 5.47       | 5.78        | 5.47       |  |
| Earnings per share (₹ 10 each) (for continuing operations) :                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |               |            |             |            |  |
| a. Basic (₹)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 0.65          | 0.87       | 0.64        | 2.67       |  |
| b. Diluted (₹)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 0.65          | 0.87       | 0.64        | 2.67       |  |
| Capital Redemption Reserve                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | NA            | NA         | NA          | NA         |  |
| Debt Redemption Reserve                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NA            | NA         | NA          | NA         |  |
| Debt Service Coverage Ratio                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | NA            | NA         | NA          | NA         |  |
| Interest Service Coverage Ratio                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | NA            | NA         | NA          | NA         |  |
| <b>Notes :</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |               |            |             |            |  |
| 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Statement of Unaudited Financial Results filed with Stock Exchange under Regulations 33 and 52 read with Regulation 63(2) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation 2015. The full format of the Unaudited Financial Results are available on the BSE Ltd website (URL : <a href="http://www.bseindia.com/corporates">www.bseindia.com/corporates</a> ) and Company's website, <a href="http://www.sakthifinance.com">www.sakthifinance.com</a> . The full Unaudited Financial Results can be accessed by scanning the QR code given below. |               |            |             |            |  |
| 2. Disclosures in accordance with Regulations 52(4) read with Regulation 63(2) of the Listing Regulations have been submitted to BSE Limited and the disclosures can be accessed on the BSE website (URL : <a href="http://www.bseindia.com/corporates">www.bseindia.com/corporates</a> ) and Company's website, <a href="http://www.sakthifinance.com">www.sakthifinance.com</a> and it can be accessed by scanning the QR code given below.                                                                                                                                                                                       |               |            |             |            |  |
| By Order of the Board<br>For Sakthi Finance Limited<br><b>M. Balasubramaniam</b><br>Vice Chairman and Managing Director<br>DIN : 00377053                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |               |            |             |            |  |
| 14 August 2026<br>Coimbatore - 18                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |               |            |             |            |  |





# Gold can become a key pillar of India’s growth story, says WGC

## bl.interview

Suresh P Iyengar  
Mumbai

The demand for gold among Indian consumers has remained stable despite the sharp rise in prices in recent months. While demand in the June quarter fell 6 per cent year-on-year, consumer spending on the precious metal surged 50 per cent to ₹1.98 lakh crore, driven by higher prices. After an exceptional rally over the past two years and in early 2026, prices moderated in the second

quarter, though they remained 59 per cent higher year-on-year. The government had raised the import duty to 15 per cent and urged consumers to reduce gold purchases to curb imports. The World Gold Council, which represents the world’s leading gold mining companies, has prepared a report on making gold a growth driver for the Indian economy. Sachin Jain, Regional CEO, India, World Gold Council, speaks about the future of gold in India. Edited excerpts: What is the idea behind

Like the diamond industry, gold jewellery manufacturing must modernise and target global consumers, not just the Indian diaspora

SACHIN JAIN  
Regional CEO-India, WGC



the ‘Swarna Bharat 2047’ report? The report presents a roadmap for the gold in-

dustry, aligned with the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047. If India becomes a \$25-trillion economy, what role can gold

play? We believe the precious metal can become a major contributor to India’s long-term growth. The report was prepared after consultations with industry bodies, leading companies and government departments, including the PMO, the Ministries of Finance, Commerce, Consumer Affairs and Mines, the RBI and Invest India. What are the key pillars of the roadmap? The first is domestic gold mining. India could eventually meet 10-20 per cent of its gold demand through local production, generating in-

vestment and employment. The second is exports. India imports 700-800 tonnes of gold annually but exports only about 100 tonnes in the form of value-added jewellery. We believe exports can rise to 300-400 tonnes over 5-10 years through better manufacturing and innovation. The third is financialising household gold. The fourth focuses on younger consumers. With a median age of 28 and rising incomes, the industry must develop new products and digital-first retail experiences. The fifth is expanding gold’s role in technology. We also see opportunities in cul-

tural tourism and in strengthening India’s position in global gold markets. Why does the report recommend a Gold Board of India? Gold-related policy is currently spread across several Ministries, resulting in fragmented decision-making. We recommend a single co-ordinating body, similar to the Tea Board, to streamline policy. What is needed to boost jewellery exports? India has world-class design talent but needs stronger manufacturing. Like the dia-

mond industry, jewellery manufacturing must modernise and target global consumers, not just Indian diaspora. Gold is also a critical input for semiconductors, electronics and aerospace. As India builds manufacturing capacity in these sectors, demand for gold will increase. The industry must, therefore, look beyond jewellery and investment. We recommend three task forces covering financialisation, mining and manufacturing and exports. They will bring together government and industry to drive implementation. The World Gold Council will act as a catalyst.

| KITEX<br>KITEX GARMENTS LIMITED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|----------------------|
| CIN: L18101KL1992PLC006528                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
| Regd. Office : Bldg. No.11/496, Kizhakkambalam, Vilangu P O,Aluva, Kerala-683561 Web:www.kitexgarments.com, E-mail:sect@kitexgarments.com, Tel.91 484 2585000 Fax: 0484 2580604                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
| EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
| Rupees in lakhs, except EPS and unless otherwise stated                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
| Sl No                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Particulars                                                                                                                               | Standalone             |                        | Consolidated         |                        |                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                           | Quarter Ended          | Year Ended             | Quarter Ended        | Year Ended             |                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                           | 30.06.2026 (Unaudited) | 30.06.2025 (Unaudited) | 31.03.2026 (Audited) | 30.06.2025 (Unaudited) | 31.03.2026 (Audited) |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Total Income from operations                                                                                                              | 12,895.74              | 20,131.18              | 63,660.93            | 16,606.98              | 19,741.67            |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                    | 1,492.72               | 3,494.40               | 6,100.72             | (1,335.23)             | 2,819.67             |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                              | 1,492.72               | 3,494.40               | 7,850.72             | (1,335.23)             | 2,819.67             |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                               | 1,115.90               | 2,605.08               | 5,689.98             | (1,712.05)             | 1,930.34             |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and other Comprehensive Income (after tax) | 1,116.22               | 2,605.84               | 5,781.98             | (1,711.73)             | 1,931.09             |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Equity Share Capital                                                                                                                      | 1,995.00               | 1,995.00               | 1,995.00             | 1,995.00               | 1,995.00             |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the year                                                | -                      | -                      | 1,13,352.32          | -                      | -                    |
| 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Earnings Per Share (of Rs.1/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations):-                                                        | 0.56                   | 1.31                   | 2.85                 | (0.45)                 | 1.04                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Diluted:                                                                                                                                  | 0.56                   | 1.31                   | 2.85                 | (0.45)                 | 1.04                 |
| Note:-                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
| 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. Kindly refer Note 4 of Notes to Standalone Financial Results for the qualified opinion of Statutory Auditors. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites- www.nseindia.com, www.bseindia.com and on the Company's website-www.kitexgarments.com. The same can be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below. |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
| 2. The above unaudited financial results of the Company for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 were reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on August 14, 2026. These results have been subjected to limited review by Statutory Auditors.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
| By order of the Board<br>Sd/-<br>Sabu M Jacob<br>Chairman & Managing Director<br>DIN: 00046016                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |
| Place : Kizhakkambalam<br>Date : August 14, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                           |                        |                        |                      |                        |                      |

| GMR<br>POWER & URBAN INFRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|-------------|--|
| GMR Power and Urban Infra Limited                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| Registered Office: Unit No. 12, 18th Floor, Tower A, Building No. 5, DLF Cyber City, DLF Phase-III, Gurugram- 122002, Haryana, India. P: +91-124-663750, E: gpulcs@gmrgroup.in, W: www.gmrpowerurbaninfra.com (CIN: L45400HR2019PLC125712)                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| Extract of the Statement of Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| (₹ in Crore)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| SL No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Particulars                                                                                      | Quarter ended |                | Year ended  |             |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                  | 30 Jun 2026   | 31 Mar 2026    | 30 Jun 2025 | 31 Mar 2026 |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                  | Unaudited     | (Refer note b) | Unaudited   | Audited     |  |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Total income from operations                                                                     | 1,705.18      | 2,004.09       | 1,648.45    | 7,331.86    |  |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Profit/(loss) for the period from continuing operations (before Tax and Exceptional items)       | 8.87          | 2.30           | (80.42)     | (182.59)    |  |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net profit/(loss) for the period before Tax from continuing operations (after Exceptional items) | 8.87          | 2.30           | (14.69)     | 781.17      |  |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net (loss)/profit for the period after Tax from continuing operations (after Exceptional items)  | (35.37)       | (113.51)       | (35.01)     | 586.62      |  |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net (loss)/profit for the period after Tax from discontinued operations                          | (0.01)        | (0.05)         | 27.83       | 27.07       |  |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net (loss)/profit for the period after Tax from continuing and discontinued operations (4+5)     | (35.38)       | (113.56)       | (7.18)      | 613.69      |  |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Total comprehensive (loss)/ income for the period                                                | (33.91)       | (118.64)       | 19.59       | 598.33      |  |
| 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Paid-up equity share capital (face value of ₹5 each)                                             | 390.51        | 390.51         | 357.42      | 390.51      |  |
| 9                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Reserves (Other equity)                                                                          |               |                |             | 1,718.12    |  |
| 10                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Earnings per share (not annualised) (for Continuing and discontinued operations)                 |               |                |             |             |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Basic (in ₹)                                                                                     | (0.53)        | (1.47)         | (0.11)      | 8.26        |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Diluted (in ₹)                                                                                   | (0.53)        | (1.47)         | (0.11)      | 8.20        |  |
| Extract of the Statement of Standalone Financial Results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| (₹ in Crore)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| SL No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Particulars                                                                                      | Quarter ended |                | Year ended  |             |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                  | 30 Jun 2026   | 31 Mar 2026    | 30 Jun 2025 | 31 Mar 2026 |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                  | Unaudited     | (Refer Note b) | Unaudited   | Audited     |  |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Total income from operations                                                                     | 62.75         | 90.96          | 94.30       | 367.28      |  |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net (loss)/profit for the period before Tax and Exceptional items                                | (37.63)       | (37.32)        | (35.32)     | (118.23)    |  |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net (loss)/profit for the period before Tax after Exceptional items                              | (96.04)       | (178.53)       | 24.17       | (149.57)    |  |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net (loss)/profit for the period after Tax and Exceptional items                                 | (96.04)       | (178.53)       | 24.17       | (149.57)    |  |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Total comprehensive (loss)/ income for the period                                                | (217.29)      | (366.32)       | 1.22        | 1,041.52    |  |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Paid-up equity share capital (face value of ₹5 each)                                             | 390.51        | 390.51         | 357.42      | 390.51      |  |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Reserves (Other equity)*                                                                         |               |                |             | 3,204.49    |  |
| 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Earnings per share (not annualised)                                                              |               |                |             |             |  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Basic and Diluted (in ₹)                                                                         | (1.23)        | (2.35)         | 0.34        | (2.06)      |  |
| * Includes fair valuation through other comprehensive income of ₹(-) 9,634.40 crore for the year ended March 31, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| Notes:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| a. The above is an extract of the detailed format of unaudited quarterly results filed with the stock exchanges under regulations 33 of Listing Regulations. The unaudited quarterly financial results in the detailed format are available on Company's website viz. www.gmrpowerurbaninfra.com and on the websites of BSE (www.bseindia.com) and NSE (www.nseindia.com). The results can be accessed by scanning the QR code. |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| b. Figures for the quarter ended March 31, 2026 represent the difference between audited figures for the financial year and the limited reviewed figures for the nine months period ended December 31, 2025.                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| c. The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee in its meeting on August 13, 2026 and approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on August 14, 2026.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| For and on behalf of the Board of Directors<br>Srinivas Bommidala<br>Vice-Chairman & Managing Director (DIN - 00061464)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| Date: August 14, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |
| GMR GROUP-PUL/33/PREM ASSOCIATES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                  |               |                |             |             |  |

| THE LAKSHMI MILLS COMPANY LIMITED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------|------------|
| CIN: L17111TZ1910PLC000093                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |
| Regd. Office : 686, Avanashi Road, Coimbatore - 641 037, Phone: 0422-2245461<br>E-mail : contact@lakshmillmills.com website: www.lakshmillmills.com                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |
| Statement of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30.06.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |
| (₹.in lakhs)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |
| S.No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Particulars                                                                                                                                  | Quarter Ended |             | Year Ended |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                              | 30.06.2026    | 31.03.2026  | 30.06.2025 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                              | Unaudited     | Audited     | Unaudited  |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Total Income from Operations / Other Income                                                                                                  | 6,014.98      | 6,724.63    | 5,544.62   |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax and exceptional items                                                                          | 411.55        | 273.23      | (100.33)   |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax after exceptional items                                                                        | 411.55        | 272.38      | (100.33)   |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax after exceptional items                                                                         | 311.06        | 191.95      | (2,202.98) |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Other comprehensive income (net of tax)                                                                                                      | 15,847.10     | (12,657.04) | 4,077.39   |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)] | 16,158.16     | (12,465.09) | 1,874.41   |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Equity Share Capital                                                                                                                         | 695.55        | 695.55      | 695.55     |
| 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Other Equity as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year                                                                      | -             | -           | -          |
| 9                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Earnings Per Share (of Rs.100/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)                                                           |               |             |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | a. Basic                                                                                                                                     | 44.72         | 27.60       | (316.72)   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | b. Diluted                                                                                                                                   | 44.72         | 27.60       | (316.72)   |
| Scan the QR Code to view the above Results in detail                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |
| Notes : 1. The above unaudited financial results were reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 14.08.2026 and have been subjected to limited review by the Statutory Auditors of the Company. 2. The previous period figures have been regrouped / reclassified wherever necessary. 3. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the above results are available on the website of Stock Exchange- BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and also on the Company's website - www.lakshmillmills.com. 4. The Detailed unaudited Financial Results of the Company for the quarter ended 30th June 2026 can be accessed through the below QR Code. |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |
| Coimbatore<br>14.08.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |
| For THE LAKSHMI MILLS COMPANY LIMITED<br>CHAIRMAN & MANAGING DIRECTOR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                              |               |             |            |

| VAMSHI RUBBER LIMITED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------|
| CIN: L2510TG1985PLC016634                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| Regd. Office: "VAMSHI HOUSE", Plot No. 41, Jayabheri Enclave, Gachibowli, Hyderabad-500032, Telangana                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| E-Mail: info@vamshirubber.org, Website : www.vamshirubber.org                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| EXTRACT FROM THE UN-AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH JUNE, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| (RS. IN LAKHS)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| Sr. No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PARTICULARS                                                                                                                                 | QUARTER ENDED 30-06-2026 | QUARTER ENDED 30-06-2025 | Year Ended 31-03-2026 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                             | Unaudited (Ind AS)       | Unaudited (Ind AS)       | Audited (Ind AS)      |
| 1.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Total Income from operations                                                                                                                | 1,602.85                 | 2,350.86                 | 8,465.05              |
| 2.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax,Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                      | (74.38)                  | 28.73                    | 95.45                 |
| 3.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                | (74.38)                  | 28.73                    | 95.45                 |
| 4.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                 | (74.38)                  | 27.65                    | 66.98                 |
| 5.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Total Comprehensive Income for the period (comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (After tax) | (74.38)                  | 31.89                    | 59.50                 |
| 6.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Equity Share Capital                                                                                                                        | 420.68                   | 420.68                   | 420.68                |
| 7.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Reserves excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year                                          | 1,017.97                 | 1,064.73                 | 1,092.35              |
| 8.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Earning Per Share (after extraordinary items) (of Rs.10/- each)                                                                             | (1.77)                   | 0.76                     | 1.41                  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | (a) Basic (in Rs.)                                                                                                                          | (1.77)                   | 0.76                     | 1.41                  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | (b) Diluted (in Rs.)                                                                                                                        | (1.77)                   | 0.76                     | 1.41                  |
| NOTE:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| 1) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchanges websites, www.bseindia.com and website of the Company www.vamshirubber.org |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| 2) The Company has adopted Indian Accounting Standards under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 (Ind AS) from 1st April, 2017                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| By the Order of the Board<br>for Vamshi Rubber Limited<br>Sd/-<br>(M.RAMESH REDDY)<br>Chairman & CFO<br>DIN : 00025101                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |
| Place : Hyderabad<br>Date : 14-08-2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                             |                          |                          |                       |

| VAMA INDUSTRIES LIMITED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| CIN: L72200TG1985PLC041126                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| Regd. Off. 7-1 -24/2/D, 1st Floor, Greendale, Amerpet,Hyderabad-500016,Phone No. +91-40-6684 5534, Fax No. +91-40-2335 5821 , Email id: cs@vamaind.com, website: www.vamaind.com                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH JUNE 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| (Rs. In Lakhs) except EPS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| Sr. No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | PARTICULARS                                                                                                                                  | Quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited) | Quarter ended 31.03.2026 (Audited) | Quarter ended 30.06.2025 (Unaudited) | Year ending 31-03-2026 Audited |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Total income from operations (net)                                                                                                           | 45.26                                | 651.02                             | 154.40                               | 1,303.44                       |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                      | (154.45)                             | 12.84                              | (207.04)                             | (199.31)                       |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                 | (154.45)                             | 12.84                              | (207.04)                             | (199.31)                       |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                  | (154.45)                             | (21.92)                            | (207.04)                             | (234.07)                       |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Total comprehensive income for the period [comprising profit / (loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)] | (154.45)                             | (21.16)                            | (207.04)                             | (233.32)                       |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Equity Share Capital                                                                                                                         | 1,050.80                             | 1,050.80                           | 1,050.80                             | 1,050.80                       |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 2/- each) for continuing and discontinued operations                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Basic:                                                                                                                                       | (0.29)                               | (0.04)                             | (0.39)                               | (0.45)                         |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Diluted:                                                                                                                                     | (0.29)                               | (0.04)                             | (0.39)                               | (0.45)                         |
| Notes:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| 1. Summarised audited standalone financial results of the company is as under (Rs. In Lakhs)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| Sr. No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | PARTICULARS                                                                                                                                  | Quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited) | Quarter ended 31.03.2026 (Audited) | Quarter ended 30.06.2025 (Unaudited) | Year ending 31-03-2026 Audited |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Total income from operations                                                                                                                 | 45.26                                | 651.02                             | 367.71                               | 1,500.90                       |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Net profit before tax                                                                                                                        | (154.45)                             | 15.79                              | 6.90                                 | 36.82                          |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Net profit after tax                                                                                                                         | (154.45)                             | (18.97)                            | 6.90                                 | 2.06                           |
| 2. The financial results have been reviewed by the audit committee of the board and approved by the board of directors at their meeting held on 14th August, 2026.                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| 3. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly and Yearly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulations 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly and Yearly Financial Results are available on company's website at www.vamaind.com and the stock exchange website www.bseindia.com |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| For Vama Industries Limited<br>Sd/-<br>Achyuta Rama Raju Vegesna<br>Managing Director<br>DIN: 00997493                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |
| Place : Hyderabad<br>Date : 14-08-2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                              |                                      |                                    |                                      |                                |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                     | VERITAS<br>FINANCE      |                              |             |                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------|-------------|-------------------------|
| VERITAS FINANCE LIMITED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| formerly known as Veritas Finance Private Limited                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| CIN: U65923TN2015PLC100328, RBI Regn No: N-07.00810                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| Regd. Office: SKCL Central Square 1, South and North Wing, 7 <sup>th</sup> Floor, Unit C28-C35, CIPET Road, Thiru Vi Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai – 600 032. <a href="http://www.veritasfin.in">www.veritasfin.in</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| Statement of Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (All amounts are in INR lakhs, unless stated otherwise)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| S.No                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Particulars                                                                                         | Quarter Ended           |                              | Year Ended  |                         |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                     | 30.06.2026<br>Unaudited | 31.03.2026<br>(Refer note h) |             | 30.06.2025<br>Unaudited |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Total Income from Operations for the period / year                                                  | 52,736.18               | 51,378.35                    | 42,990.17   | 1,84,421.04             |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Net Profit for the period / year (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)               | 12,659.56               | 15,748.37                    | 8,154.88    | 43,608.25               |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Net Profit for the period / year before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)          | 12,659.56               | 15,748.37                    | 8,154.88    | 43,608.25               |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Net Profit for the period / year after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)           | 9,506.71                | 11,933.40                    | 6,165.05    | 33,039.48               |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Total Comprehensive Income for the period / year                                                    | 9,577.51                | 12,093.88                    | 6,030.28    | 32,791.08               |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Paid up Equity Share Capital                                                                        | 13,136.42               | 13,136.42                    | 13,136.42   | 13,136.42               |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)                                                            | 3,09,307.13             | 2,99,551.42                  | 2,71,781.02 | 2,99,551.42             |
| 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Securities Premium Account                                                                          | 1,71,989.46             | 1,71,989.46                  | 1,71,989.46 | 1,71,989.46             |
| 9                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Net worth (equity and preference share capital + reserve and surplus excluding revaluation reserve) | 3,22,443.55             | 3,12,687.84                  | 2,84,917.44 | 3,12,687.84             |
| 10                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt (debt securities + borrowings)                              | 7,52,539.21             | 7,37,409.70                  | 5,60,672.31 | 7,37,409.70             |
| 11                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Debt Equity Ratio (Refer note d)                                                                    | 2.33                    | 2.36                         | 1.97        | 2.36                    |
| 12                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Earnings per share (of INR 10 each) (Refer note e)                                                  |                         |                              |             |                         |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | - Basic                                                                                             | 7.24                    | 9.09                         | 4.70        | 25.17                   |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | - Diluted                                                                                           | 7.21                    | 9.04                         | 4.66        | 24.99                   |
| 13                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Capital Redemption Reserve                                                                          | -                       | -                            | -           | -                       |
| 14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Debenture Redemption Reserve (Refer note f)                                                         | -                       | -                            | -           | -                       |
| 15                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Debt Service Coverage Ratio (Refer note g)                                                          | -                       | -                            | -           | -                       |
| 16                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Interest Service Coverage Ratio (Refer note g)                                                      | -                       | -                            | -           | -                       |
| Notes :                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (a) Veritas Finance Limited ("the Company") is a company limited by shares domiciled in India and incorporated on 30 April 2015 under the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 registered with Reserve Bank of India ("RBI") and is classified under middle layer as per scale based regulations issued by RBI to carry on the business of NBFC without accepting public deposits. The debt securities of the Company namely non-convertible debentures are listed on the Bombay Stock Exchange ("BSE") and National Stock Exchange ("NSE"). The Company is engaged in extending credit to micro and small enterprises, typically self-employed businesses and salaried segment for the purpose of their business expansion, working capital, construction of houses, and purchase of used commercial vehicles. |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (b) The financial results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026 are available on the websites of BSE ( <a href="https://www.bseindia.com">https://www.bseindia.com</a> ), NSE ( <a href="https://www.nseindia.com">https://www.nseindia.com</a> ) and the Company ( <a href="https://www.veritasfin.in/announcement-and-results.php">https://www.veritasfin.in/announcement-and-results.php</a> ).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (c) These unaudited financial results have been prepared in accordance with recognition and measurement principles laid down in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standard ("Ind AS") 34 - "Interim Financial Reporting" as prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act"), read with the Companies (Indian Accounting standards) Rules, 2015, as amended from time to time, and other accounting principles generally accepted in India and in terms of Regulation 52 of the Securities Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015 (as amended). Any application guidance/ clarifications/ directions issued by the Reserve Bank of India are implemented as and when they are issued/ become applicable.                     |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| The statement of unaudited financial results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026, have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and subsequently approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on 14 August 2026. This statement of unaudited financial results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026, have been subjected to limited review by the statutory auditor of the Company.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (d) Debt equity ratio is calculated as ((Debt securities + Borrowings) / Net worth)).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (e) Earnings per share disclosed for the quarter ended 30 June 2026, 31 March 2026 and 30 June 2025 have not been annualised.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (f) Debenture redemption reserve is not required in respect of privately placed debentures in terms of Rule 18(7)(b)(ii) of Companies (Share Capital and Debenture) Rules, 2014.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (g) Debt service coverage ratio and Interest service coverage ratio is not applicable for Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC) and accordingly no disclosure has been made.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| (h) Figures for the quarter ended 31 March 2026, are derived by deducting the reported year to date figures for the period ended 31 December 2025, which were subjected to limited review, from audited figures for the year ended 31 March 2026.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| for and on behalf of the board of directors of<br>Veritas Finance Limited (formerly known as Veritas Finance Private Limited)<br>Sd/-<br>D. Arulmany<br>Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |
| Place : Chennai<br>Date : 14.08.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                     |                         |                              |             |                         |



QUICKLY.

**Gold up as inflation data  
cements rate hold bets**



Gold advanced on Friday, buoyed by a weaker dollar after in-line US inflation readings this week tipped the scales in favour of an interest rate hold. Spot gold gained 0.6 per cent to \$4,386.30 per ounce by 1309 GMT. US gold futures rose 0.3 per cent to \$4,407.50. Silver climbed one per cent to \$65.08 per ounce. **REUTERS**

**Copper drifts lower  
on profit taking**

**London:** Copper and aluminium prices edged lower as investors locked in profits from a rally amid uncertainty about the global economy and the unresolved conflict in West Asia. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME slipped 0.1 per cent to \$14,133 a tonne. Aluminium fell 0.4 per cent to \$3,244. **REUTERS**

**Crude oil eyes weekly  
gains on geopolitical woes**



Crude oil prices were on track for weekly gains after the US threatened an indefinite naval blockade of Iran, raising concerns about disruptions to crude supplies from West Asia. Brent futures were up 25 cents to \$87.32 a barrel at 1205 GMT. US WTI futures were up 49 cents to \$81.74. Brent and WTI were on track for weekly gains of about 4.5 per cent. **REUTERS**

# Centre asks mills to give bulk sugar sales data by Aug 20

**TACKLING PRICE SURGE.** Orders buyers to take delivery within 7 days of purchase; ‘certain mills holding stocks in excess of or selling less than allocation’

**Prabhudatta Mishra**  
New Delhi

The Union government on Friday asked sugar mills to ensure that buyers lift stocks within seven days after sales. It said a new order, issued by the Food Ministry with immediate effect, will be valid until November 30. The Ministry, on August 13, issued the order to sugar mills asking them to furnish bulk sales data during the 2025-26 fiscal. “It has been observed that certain sugar mills are holding stocks of sugar in excess of the quantities reported in P2 form or selling less sugar than the allocated monthly quota. The said discrepancy has also been confirmed during the recently conducted drive for physical verifica-

tion of sugar stocks by the department,” according to the letter issued by the Director (Sugar Division) to all the mills. **GOVT’S WARNING** The government has reminded mills that under Section 3 and 7 of the Essential Commodities Act, 1955 read with Sugar (Control) Order, 2025, it is empowered to take legal action against any mill for furnishing any misleading or incorrect information regarding sugar stocks. Further, the letter said that the department had found that certain mills were selling sugar at the beginning of the month, but the dispatch/lifting is being done by buyers at the end of the month. “This practice results in creation of artificial scarcity

| Zooming retail price (₹/kg) |             | Variation (%) |             |             |              |  |
|-----------------------------|-------------|---------------|-------------|-------------|--------------|--|
|                             | 1 year ago  | 6 month ago   | 3 month ago | 1 month ago | Aug-12, 2026 |  |
| West Bengal                 | 7.34        | 6.94          | 6.7         | 1.22        | 51.62        |  |
| Delhi                       | 8.89        | 4.26          | 4.26        | 4.26        | 49.00        |  |
| Uttar Pradesh               | 9.69        | 8.45          | 8.07        | 6.68        | 48.89        |  |
| Maharashtra                 | 14.74       | 14.46         | 14.62       | 11.84       | 51.21        |  |
| Karnataka                   | 15.77       | 16.65         | 16.26       | 13.89       | 51.91        |  |
| <b>All India average</b>    | <b>9.92</b> | <b>9.37</b>   | <b>9.02</b> | <b>7.68</b> | <b>50.77</b> |  |

Source: Dept of Consumer Affairs

of sugar in the market,” it said. “In view of the prevailing scenario regarding involvement of certain mills in speculative activities, it has been decided that no mill shall retain sugar stock in its premises for more than seven days after sale to any dealer, agent or bulk consumer, except in circumstances beyond its control,” the letter said. **PRICES UP 8%** Any violation of the above instructions shall be viewed seriously and appropriate legal action shall be initiated by the government, it said. The intensive check/physical verification drive of sugar stocks, which started from August 1 and was scheduled to end on August 14, will continue by the Central and State government teams, it said.

The All-India average prices of sugar have increased 8 per cent in the retail market and 7 per cent in the wholesale market in the past month, according to Consumer Affairs Ministry data. **ANOTHER FIAT** Sensing that there may be lower sugar available with mills, the government on July 24 announced physical verification of stock and to complete the exercise by August 14. Besides, stock limit was imposed on July 28 prescribing maximum 400 tonnes of sugar that traders can keep at any point of time till November 30. In a separate Order on August 13, the Food Ministry asked all mills furnish by August 20 bulk consumer-wise

details to whom 500 tonnes or more sugar had been sold annually directly or through agents during FY 2025-26. Mills need to duly specify names of bulk consumers, total quantity supplied to each bulk consumer during 2025-26 fiscal. Officials said accurate and comprehensive information regarding the quantity of sugar supplied to bulk consumers is essential for effective monitoring of stocks, domestic availability and consumption patterns. Under the Sugar (Control) Order, 2025, “bulk consumer” is defined as *hawai*, sweetmeat seller, confectioner, soft drink manufacturer, food processing industry or any other institutional buyer consuming not less than 100 tonnes of sugar as average monthly

consumption during last year, excluding the current month. **BUILDING DATA** Sources said that the government wants to build a data base of bulk consumers, who are perceived to buy 65 per cent of total consumption, for which the information has been sought. But, industry sources said that it is difficult to find out who is a bulk consumer as some broker or trader could have lifted 500 tonnes per year for onwards sales. “Will the government ask all the sugar traders to get registered and file monthly return like sugar mills do,” asked an industry official and added that it is not physically possible to get exact information without introducing “inspector raj”.

## Coconut oil, copra prices rise ahead of Onam demand

**V Sajeev Kumar**  
Kochi

The upcoming Onam festival demand has started pushing coconut oil prices up after they remained subdued for several months. Wholesale prices are ruling around ₹260 a kg in Kerala, compared with ₹242 in Tamil Nadu. Copra prices have also moved up to ₹168 a kg in Kerala and ₹163 in Tamil Nadu, according to traders. They said the price rise was artificially created by vested interests in the neighbouring State to cash in on the Onam season by holding copra stocks, despite sufficient availability in the market. However, they said the

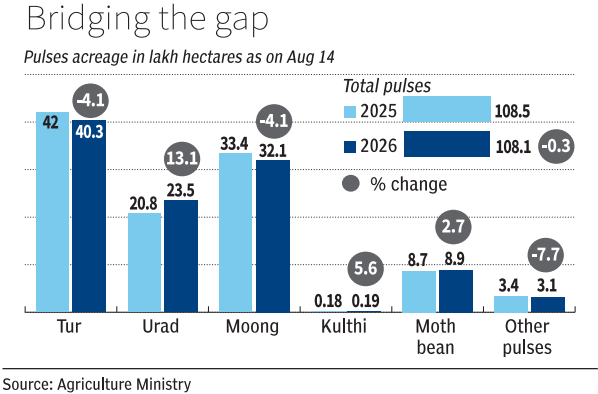
market had remained steady over the past few days, as procurement agencies reportedly withdrew from purchases following the price surge. This forced millers to moderate prices. Coconut oil touched a record price of more than ₹500 a kg in July 2025. **SUPPLIES IMPROVE** Thalath Mahmood, President of the Cochin Oil Merchants Association (COMA), said the ongoing harvest season in several producing States had ensured adequate availability of copra, and there was no justification for the price rise. The upward trend is expected to ease once the festival season is over, he said. Raw coconut prices, however, have risen to around ₹65 a kg.

KK Devraj, a consultant to the coconut oil industry, said improved local arrivals and better regional crop yields, following last year’s severe pest attacks and weather disruptions, had helped ease supply constraints. Onam traditionally drives a 10-20 per cent increase in local demand. Demand is expected to remain firm through the festival period, supported by household cooking requirements, industrial production of sweets and snacks, and subsequent pan-India demand ahead of other festivals. Unlike previous years, when severe shortages triggered sharp price spikes, improved raw material availability is expected to cap inflation and prevent extreme fluctuations, Devraj added.

## Pulses acreage on par with last year’s level

**Vishwanath Kulkarni**  
Bengaluru

The overall pulses acreage has nearly caught up with last year’s level, aided by a recovery in monsoon rainfall across several States. According to the latest data, the area under pulses as of August 14 stood at 108.14 lakh hectares (lh), marginally lower than the 108.49 lh recorded in the corresponding period last year. Though acreage under tur and moong is down 4 per cent each, largely due to deficient rainfall in key producing States such as Karnataka and Maharashtra, adequate stocks in the country are expected to ease supply concerns, stakeholders said. Higher tur coverage in Uttar Pradesh, Telangana, Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh has



more than offset the decline in Karnataka, Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh. In Karnataka, tur acreage as of August 14 was down about 23 per cent at 10.53 lh (13.72 lh last year), while in Maharashtra it stood at 11.79 lh (12.06 lh). In Madhya Pradesh, tur area fell 22 per cent to 2.51 lh (3.24 lh).

**NOT A WORRY** In Gujarat, tur acreage rose 9 per cent to 2.38 lh (2.19 lh), while Telangana recorded a 7 per cent increase to 2.02 lh (1.88 lh). In Andhra Pradesh, tur acreage rose 16 per cent to 1.78 lh (1.53 lh), while Uttar Pradesh saw a 39 per cent increase to 4.92 lh (3.53 lh). “Shortfall in tur and moong acreage is not a cause

for concern as there are enough stocks. The government has 1.2 million tonnes in stock, besides supplies at ports and with farmers and traders. There was initially some concern over lower urad acreage, but it has now surpassed last year’s level, which should support output. If September receives the forecast rain, yields are likely to improve,” said Satish Upadhyay, Honorary Secretary, India Pulses and Grains Association. In urad (black matpe), higher acreage in Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan has offset the decline in Maharashtra. Urad area rose 65 per cent in Uttar Pradesh to 6.11 lh (3.69 lh), 28 per cent in Rajasthan to 3.99 lh (3.12 lh) and 19 per cent in Madhya Pradesh to 7.07 lh (5.92 lh). Moong acreage was almost flat in Rajasthan at 23.06 lh (23.24 lh).

## 70% of global ricebran oil potential remains untapped: SEA

**Our Bureau**  
Mangaluru

Around 70 per cent of the world’s ricebran oil potential remains untapped and that needs to be explored, according to BV Mehta, Executive Director of the Solvent Extractors’ Association of India (SEA). Presenting the India country report at the ‘International Conference on Rice Bran Oil 2026’ in Bangkok on Thursday, he said there is a potential for around 8 million tonnes (mt) of rice bran oil in the world. However, the current global ricebran oil production stands at 2.4 mt. There is scope to produce another 5.55 mt of ricebran oil across the globe, he said. **MAJOR PRODUCERS** Stating that India and China are the major ricebran oil producers in the world, he said India’s production



stands at around 1.1 mt and China’s at 0.74 mt. Despite being the major producer of ricebran oil, India’s potential is still to be tapped. There is a potential to produce a total of 2.3 mt in India. Indian efforts are relatively better, but still a lot needs to be done. Mehta said India is estimated to produce around 230 mt of paddy and 154 mt of rice in 2025-26. This translates into an estimated 13.1 mt of ricebran, with the potential to produce nearly 2.3 mt of oil. India is currently producing only around 1.1 mt of ricebran oil, leaving an es-

timated 1.2 mt of untapped potential. **NEED FOR R&D** Stating that the opportunity had grown significantly over the past decade, he said ricebran oil potential had risen from 1.6 mt in 2016-17 to 2.3 mt in 2025-26. Yet, actual ricebran oil production had increased much more slowly, from around 0.98 mt to 1.10 mt. India is generating more rice bran, but a substantial part of its oil potential is still waiting to be unlocked. Unlocking this potential will require a coordinated value-chain approach, beginning with better economics for ricebran extraction and processing. Mehta also laid stress on the need for greater research and development support for low-lipase paddy varieties, stronger and modernised rice-milling infrastructure, and incentives for bran stabilisation at rice mills.

## Easing West Asia tensions revive orthodox tea demand at Kochi auctions

**V Sajeev Kumar**  
Kochi

Easing tensions in West Asia appear to have helped revive the orthodox tea market at the Kochi auctions, with overseas buyers showing strong demand. According to traders, the orthodox segment is on the revival path as concerns over the war have eased, prompting exporters to step up shipments. This was reflected in the 98 per cent sales recorded in sale 33, out of the 2,38,637 kg offered. The average price realisation also increased by ₹4 a kg to ₹177. Auctioneers Forbes, Ewart & Figgis said medium whole-leaf teas witnessed strong buying interest, with margins of ₹5-10 and sometimes more. Broken teas were steady to firm, while the lesser grades were firm to dearer. Anil George Joseph, President of the Tea Trade Asso-

ciation of Cochin, said continued participation by buyers from West Asia and the CIS supported the orthodox market, particularly for premium-quality teas. Larger whole-leaf grades gained ₹3-5 a kg, depending on quality, while primary broken teas appreciated by more than ₹5 a kg. **POSITIVE OUTLOOK** The immediate outlook remains positive for both CTC and orthodox teas, with the latter showing stronger upward momentum. Quality will remain the key differentiator. However, increased availability of plain CTC could keep lower-quality teas under pressure, he said. The auctioneers said the CTC dust market was firm, with good-liquoring teas fetching ₹1-2 more. The offered quantity was 7,11,269 kg, while the average price realisation increased by ₹2 to ₹155.

## ISMA, ICAR’s cane research arm to set up ₹80-crore seed centre

**Our Bureau**  
New Delhi

The Indian Sugar & Bio-Energy Manufacturers Association (ISMA) on Wednesday said it has signed an MoU with the ICAR-Indian Sugarcane Research Institute (ICAR-ISRI), Lucknow, to establish an Advanced Centre for Quality Sugarcane Seed Production for mills in Uttar Pradesh and the subtropical region. The Centre, proposed to be set up on ISRI’s Lucknow campus with an estimated investment of about ₹80 crore on a 50:50 basis, will serve as a hub for strengthening the quality sugarcane seed ecosystem, including production and farmer adoption. It will help replace pest- and insect-prone varieties and provide farmers with technical and scientific support. The farmer-centric initiative aims to establish a science-based system for the



multiplication and distribution of disease-free, genetically pure and high-yielding sugarcane planting material. **MONITOR QUALITY** The programme will also support seed quality monitoring, field-performance assessment, training of cane development personnel and largescale adoption through participating sugar mills, ensuring that research reaches farmers effectively. ISMA thanked Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, ICAR Director-General Mangi Lal Jat, Deputy Director-General (Crop Science) DK Yadav,

ISRI Director SN Sushil and Food Ministry Joint Secretary (Sugar) Ashwini Srivastava for their support, saying the Centre of Excellence would help build a stronger and more sustainable sugarcane ecosystem. The Centre will ensure assured production and timely supply of quality planting material of improved, recommended, released and promising new varieties, with a defined annual production capacity. It will support the systematic replacement and diversification of sugarcane varieties across participating sugar mill command areas to improve cane productivity and sugar recovery, and enhance the long-term sustainability of cultivation. Disease-free seed production will be a key focus, with certification and regular quality monitoring to maintain the health and genetic purity of planting material. Systematic tagging and digital traceability of seed lots will also be introduced.

## Chinese astronauts grow rice in space for the first time

Shenzhou-23 crew harvested the first batch, grown from seeds taken to the Chinese Space Station in May

**Our Bureau**  
Chennai

It was something even Steven Spielberg didn’t imagine in his science fiction movies. But the Chinese have done it. Their astronauts have harvested rice for the first time in space. The crew of Shenzhou-23, an ongoing Chinese space mission, successfully harvested the first batch of rice grown from seeds taken to the Chinese Space Station in May, according to the Chinese daily *Global Times*. The harvested rice included seeds that were generated in orbit in 2022. The development could

support future *in situ* (on-site) food production beyond Earth, the daily said, quoting China Central Television (CCTV). It is also being seen as a sustainable food production effort that could source supplies on its own rather than depend on resupply from Earth. **PURPOSE OF EXPERIMENT** *China Science Daily* said the purpose of this experiment is to explore the genetic stability and regenerative capacity of rice in a micro-gravity environment. The astronauts carried Japonica rice seeds to space. The Japonica variety adapts well and has a 3-4-month



**SPACE FARMERS.** Astronauts Zhu Yangzhu, Zhang Zhiyuan and Lai Ka-ying attending a press conference ahead of the Shenzhou-23 spaceflight mission **REUTERS**

growth cycle. The seeds comprised two groups — the first consisted of seeds that never left the Earth’s surface, and the other consisted of those harvested in orbit in 2022. These were then bred for three seasons on Earth. The Shenzhou-23 space-

craft was launched on May 24. It carried rice seeds and other experimental materials to China’s space station. Since entering China’s space station, three astronauts — Zhu Yangzhu, Zhang Zhiyuan and Lai Ka-ying — carried out a series of experiments.

They completed the collection and storage of the first batch of rice samples for the mission’s first experiment on the molecular mechanisms of multi-generational genetic stability and environmental adaptability in space-grown rice a few days ago. The experiment’s objective is to cultivate two consecutive generations of rice in orbit — from seed to seed — enabling scientists to investigate how prolonged exposure to micro-gravity influences the crop’s genetic stability, the *Global Times* report said. China had carried out the world’s first seed-to-seed rice cultivation experiment in orbit in 2022.

‘More than 90% risk of a very strong El Nino’

**Reuters**

El Nino is strengthening, with a greater than 90 per cent chance of a very strong event during the Northern Hemisphere fall and winter 2026-27, the US Climate Prediction Center said on Thursday. “During October-December 2026 season, there is 69 per cent chance of a historic event that would exceed the strength of previous El Nino events dating back to 1950,” the weather forecaster said. El Nino occurs when weakening trade winds cause warmer ocean waters to build up in the central and eastern equatorial Pacific. This typically leads to higher global temperatures and altered weather patterns.

## Mumbai to host CLFMA annual meet on Sept 11-12

**Our Bureau**  
Bengaluru

The Compound Livestock Feed Manufacturers Association (CLFMA) of India will host its 59<sup>th</sup> annual general meeting (AGM) and 67<sup>th</sup> National Symposium on September 11-12 in Mumbai. Centred on the theme, “Animal Agriculture – The Backbone of Sustainable Development,” the two-day event will see policymakers, industry leaders, academicians, researchers, farmers and allied stakeholders discuss the future of India’s animal agriculture sector, CLFMA said in a statement.

**KEY PRIORITIES** The discussions will focus on

sustainability, animal nutrition, feed innovation, technology adoption, policy support and international trade, while encouraging greater collaboration between the government, industry and academia, CLFMA said. Divya Kumar Gulati, Chairman, CLFMA of India, said, “India’s animal agriculture sector has become increasingly important to the country’s food security, rural economy and agricultural growth.” “Through this year’s national symposium, CLFMA aims to facilitate meaningful dialogue that encourages innovation, supports evidence-based policymaking and advances sustainable growth across the animal agriculture value chain,” Gulati added.







QUICKLY.

**SpaceX buys AI start-up  
Cursor for \$60 billion**



SpaceX has completed a \$60 billion acquisition of artificial intelligence coding start-up Cursor, a key part of Elon Musk's bid to gain ground on Anthropic and OpenAI. The deal became effective on August 14, according to a regulatory filing, two months after SpaceX announced the acquisition. **BLOOMBERG**

**Tata Steel to sell  
Jamshedpur FC for ₹100**

**New Delhi:** Tata Steel on Friday said the company will sell its entire stake in Jamshedpur Football and Sporting Private Limited to Churchill Brothers Sports Club for a nominal amount of ₹100. Jamshedpur Football and Sporting Private Limited (JFSPL) is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the steel major. **PTI**

# Airbus’ initial report flags temporary malfunction of flight-control systems

**FALL IN ALTITUDE.** Assessment identifies hydraulic system loss; Airbus team in India to assist AAIB

**Rohit Vaid**  
New Delhi



**SERIOUS INCIDENT.** The assessment was based on decoded digital flight data recorder data and the post flight report **REUTERS**

A preliminary assessment by Airbus into the August 4 Air India Phuket-Delhi flight incident has identified a loss of the aircraft’s hydraulic system that resulted in a temporary malfunction of multiple flight-control systems.

The initial assessment report sent from Airbus to Air India on August 4 had said the aircraft’s control on elevators and aileron surfaces were lost for around four seconds during the occurrence.

Notably, the assessment was based on decoded digital flight data recorder (DFDR) data and the post flight report (PFR), relating to the Airbus A320neo that suffered a sudden loss of altitude of around 300 feet during the flight.

However, sources said the preliminary report is dated and subject to changes as the

investigation progresses. Besides, the initial Airbus assessment said the incident requires a detailed analysis covering both aircraft systems and structural integrity, as the aircraft may have been affected by the sudden movement.

**OPERATIONAL TESTS** Meanwhile, the preliminary assessment prescribed a series of operational tests of the hydraulic systems, along with tests of the system pressure switches, pressure

transducers and associated indicating systems. Furthermore, Airbus has sought information on recent maintenance activities carried out on the aircraft’s hydraulic system. Earlier a post-flight maintenance report of flight AI2379 flagged multiple warnings involving faults in the aircraft’s hydraulic and flight-control systems. In another development, a three-member specialised team from Airbus is currently in India to examine

the Air India aircraft involved in the incident, multiple sources told *businessline*. The team, sources said, is assisting with the ongoing investigation into the occurrence, which has been designated as a ‘Serious Incident’.

**CONTROL SYSTEMS** At present, the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) is examining all aspects related to the incident, including turbulence, drug-test results and any faults in the aircraft’s hydraulic and flight-control systems. Earlier, sources in the Ministry of Civil Aviation told *businessline* that the preliminary report into the August 4 Air India flight AI2379 incident is expected to be completed within the next 10-15 days. Following the preliminary investigation report by the AAIB, sources said the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) will decide on

any action against the stakeholder involved in the incident. “Fines and management liability cannot be ruled out at this stage,” sources said. However, sources clarified that these proposed actions can only be decided after the preliminary investigation report is out. Apart from fines and management liability, enhanced surveillance measures on the airline may also be imposed, depending on the findings of the investigation, sources said. In terms of investigation, the AAIB had summoned the pilots and crew of AI2379 for questioning as part of its investigation into the incident. Additionally, the AAIB is collaborating with the French civil aviation regulator, Air India and Airbus. The incident involved an Airbus A320neo, registered VT-EXO, in which 20 passengers and four crew members were injured.

# Fractal Analytics beta launches India’s first healthcare AI model

**Vallari Sanzgiri**  
Mumbai



Suraj Amonkar, Chief AI and Research Officer, Fractal Analytics

Fractal Analytics on Friday launched India’s first reasoning model with a focus on healthcare under the IndiaAI Mission, with beta testing starting off in Mumbai. The pilot in partnership with the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) will provide a Health AI Chatbot on WhatsApp powered by Vaidya AI over the next few weeks. The model will integrate datasets starting with six places in Mumbai, including two large hospitals, to streamline citizen access to immediate healthcare information. The initiative will eventually be implemented across various BMC facilities, from dispensaries to major hospitals including KEM, with a privacy-first architecture. The chatbot will also support clinical workflows and strengthen public health decision-making at scale. “The health information and the accuracy of the health information is very high. We are competing with Frontier AI Labs globally. The model will give you information to anything that helps you answer your queries but it is not a replacement for a doctor. It won’t do diagnosis,” said Suraj Amonkar, Chief AI and Research Officer, Fractal.

to provide AI-guided pre-consultation support for doctors to highlight patient complaints, self-reported medical history and medication details before a consultation in future. This will include follow-up queries by the LLM on the ailments flagged by the patient. Further it will provide a Public Health Intelligence Dashboard for healthcare administrators with anonymized, aggregated insights from laboratory reports.

**CLINICAL DECISIONS** “Vaidya.ai represents an important step in leveraging AI to strengthen healthcare delivery. As we evaluate this pilot across selected BMC facilities, our focus is on improving patient experience, supporting healthcare professionals and enabling more informed public health decision-making, while ensuring that clinical decisions remain with qualified medical professionals,” said Ashwini Bhide, Municipal Commissioner, Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation. Fractal has built Vaidya.ai which is world’s first AI model to score above 50 on OpenAI’s HealthBench (Hard), outperforming GPT-5 and Gemini Pro 3. The model combines multi-lingual and multimodal capabilities with Responsible AI principles.

# ‘Public trust in aviation will not be allowed to be broken’

**Rohit Vaid**  
New Delhi

The government will not allow public trust in India’s aviation sector to be compromised due to the recent Air India Phuket-Delhi flight-related incidents, Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu Kinjarapu told *businessline*, adding that all necessary steps will be undertaken to enhance safe operations. “The assertion comes even as investigations into “all significant aspects” are ongoing in the recent Air India incident in which an Airbus

A320neo, registered VT-EXO, lost 300 feet of altitude within seconds, injuring 20 passengers and four crew members. The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) is examining aspects related to the incident, including turbulence, pilots’ drug-test results and any faults in the aircraft’s flight-control systems.

**SUCCESS OF AVIATION** “The trust of the public in aviation is what led to the success of aviation in India in the first place. In no way will we ever allow that trust to break,” Naidu said. “All significant aspects re-



Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu Kinjarapu

garding the incident are being investigated and AAIB will soon come out with a report.” The Minister said that

MoCA (Ministry of Civil Aviation) would ensure that incidents such as these do not recur. However, he said that it was too early to draw conclusions or to take effective measures before the completion of a proper investigation. According to Naidu, stringent steps would be undertaken to strengthen the existing Civil Aviation Requirements (CARs) if any shortcomings were identified during the investigation. “India remains one of the safest aviation markets in the world,” he added. Meanwhile, the preliminary report into the August 4

Air India flight AI2379 incident is expected to be completed within the next 10-15 days, sources have told *businessline*.

**POSSIBLE ACTION** Following the preliminary investigation report by the AAIB, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) will decide on any action against Air India, sources said. As per sources, the regulator will “not micro-manage any airline’s operations but will fix liability.” Sources said ensuring compliance with regulatory requirements and established procedures is the re-

sponsibility of the airline’s management. “All options are on the table, including stringent action and strictures against Air India. Fines and management liability cannot be ruled out at this stage,” sources said. Nevertheless, they clarified that these proposed actions can only be decided after the preliminary investigation report is out. Apart from fines and management liability, enhanced surveillance measures on the airline may also be imposed, depending on the findings of the investigation, sources said.

# E-comm platforms dial back discounts as mid-year sales growth moderates

**Jyoti Banthia**  
Bengaluru



E-commerce platforms are likely to dial back deep discounts during the upcoming mid-year sales as they face pressure to improve profitability, while consumer spending remains cautious amid higher costs. Industry analysts expect growth during the sales events to moderate to around 8-10 per cent this year, even as demand remains healthy across the broader online retail market. “Companies are under pressure to show profitability... they are not in a phase where they can spend a lot in discounting,” said Satish Meena, analyst at Datum Intelligence. He added that discounts are unlikely to disappear but

will become more targeted and category-specific. According to Meena, the upcoming sales could see growth of only 8-10 per cent over last year, compared with the 20-25 per cent growth typically expected from such events. However, he said this should not be extrapolated to the overall e-commerce market, which continues to see healthy demand across categories.

“We are seeing a demand across categories. It’s not the business spending in the market. Just the sales timing was tricky,” Meena said.

**SMARTPHONE SALES** Higher costs are also affecting high-value categories such as smartphones and laptops, where consumers could defer purchases in anticipation of better discounts or new product launches during Diwali. Smartphone shipments, for instance, could decline in volume even as the value of sales remains relatively resilient because of higher prices, Meena said. Consumer caution is also weighing on the near-term pace of spending. “Consumers are most certainly more circumspect in their spending today,” said brand

strategist Harish Bijoor, adding that higher petroleum prices have cascaded into costs across food, clothing and shelter. **Q-COMM GROWTH** Quick commerce is meanwhile gaining a larger share of last-minute festive purchases, particularly toys, gifts, stationery, home decor, small appliances and electronics, Meena said. Despite the softer mid-year numbers, analysts expect spending to pick up during the main festive season, when consumers have planned purchases. Meena said the mid-year events therefore provide only a limited read on festive demand, as consumers may be deliberately holding back purchases for larger Diwali offers.

**Ankita Upadhyay**  
New Delhi

The proposed health insurance reforms could reshape how hospitals, insurers and patients interact, with the government looking at standardised treatment rates, common insurance coverage and wider adoption of the National Health Claims Exchange (NHCEX). While the reforms are aimed at containing rising healthcare costs and improving transparency, industry experts say the success of the exercise will depend on whether it addresses the price of treatment and the underlying cost of delivering quality care. Gurmeet Singh, Vice-President and Head-Health Underwriting at Iffco-Tokio

General Insurance, said he sees standardised treatment rates and a common claims platform as important steps towards making health insurance more efficient and affordable. Siddhartha Bhattacharya, Secretary General of NATHEALTH, however, argued that “we must look beyond fixing rates and address the structural cost of delivery faced by healthcare providers to deliver quality outcomes”. **WELCOME STEP** Singh described the proposed reforms as a “welcome step”, particularly for lower-middle-income households. “If they standardise these costs in private hospitals and government hospitals, then overall, for tertiary care, super speciality hospitals, the



expenditure will always be in tolerable limits,” he said. He also backed the NHCEX, describing a health claims exchange as “the correct way for the future”. However, Singh cautioned that the platform would have to be properly integrated across stakeholders and implemented consistently. **DRAWBACKS** According to Singh, fraud

and abuse could account for around 5-10 per cent of claims. Standardisation, he said, could potentially reduce claim costs by 8-10 per cent. Bhattacharya, meanwhile, warned that imposing rates without understanding the economics of healthcare will make quality healthcare financially unsustainable. “For healthcare providers, the cost starts well before a patient enters the facility. Hospitals also have to comply with multiple regulatory and operational requirements,” he said. He also highlighted delayed payments as a major problem for hospitals. “Pay on time,” he said, arguing that claims should ideally be settled within 15 or 30 days rather than taking six or 12 months.

# Onam retail subdued, but garments stitch some hope

Shorter calendar window, rain and liquidity constraints lead to ad slump and slow festive momentum

**V Sajeew Kumar**  
Kochi

Onam, Kerala’s 10-day harvest festival that is the key economic bellwether for India’s lucrative festive season, faces a subdued start due to a shorter calendar window, recent rain and floods, and liquidity constraints from global tensions. While white goods struggle and ad spends drop a steep 35 per cent, garment retailers like Kalyan Silks project strong late growth. Gopu Nandilath, Chairman of Nandilath GMart, rued that the expected festive surge in sales had not happened. “The business will be vibrant only when Onam is lengthy and falls across August and September. This year, the season is too short, with sales taking place mainly in just one month till August 26,” he

told *businessline*. However, he expects demand to pick up during the final 10 days of the season. “We are expecting a revival in the market in the final 10 days of Onam, with business expected to surge by 15-20 per cent compared with last year,” he said. The market for white goods and other home appliances in Kerala during the festival season is estimated around ₹3,000 crore.

**GLIMMER OF HOPE** The garment sector, meanwhile, is more optimistic, banking on the strong tradition of gifting clothes during Onam. EP George of Kerala Textiles and Garments Association said demand had been encouraging since the beginning of the season and is expected to sustain in the coming weeks. Onam-related gar-



**HARVEST SEASON.** Onam-related garment sales in Kerala are estimated at ₹5,000-7,000 crore, with the sector expecting 5-10 per cent growth over last year **NIRMAL HARINDRAN**

ment sales in Kerala are estimated at ₹5,000-7,000 crore, with the sector expecting 5-10 per cent growth over last year. However, the recent floods in Kottayam and Pathanamthitta districts affected sales and caused losses for several traders, George said. With the crucial final days of Onam approaching, retailers and brands are hoping that a late revival in consumer spending will

cific sales period with a growth of around 20-25 per cent,” he said.

**CONSIDERABLE SHIFT** Dominic Savio, a Kochi-based brand strategist, said Kerala’s Onam economy has seen a considerable shift in recent years, largely due to consumer offers being rolled out throughout the year. As a result, spending that was once concentrated in a few weeks around Onam is increasingly being distributed throughout the year. This has shifted consumer purchase cycles from occasions to opportunities. The recent floods in several districts have also affected consumer purchasing power, further dampening spending during the festive season, he said. Quoting industry estimates, Savio said brands collectively spent between

₹1,100 crore and ₹1,400 crore on media in Kerala during the last Onam season. This year, market expectations are considerably more subdued, with total ad spending unlikely to cross ₹1,000 crore. This represents a significant contraction in what has traditionally been Kerala’s most lucrative advertising window. If spending settles closer to ₹850-900 crore, as some expect, the decline could be as steep as 35-40 per cent from last year’s upper estimate. For media companies grappling with fragmented audiences and advertising budgets shifting towards digital platforms and influencers, a weak Onam season is more than just a festive blip. It could translate into a significant hit to advertising revenues, Savio said.

# Crackdown on q-comm units by Maharashtra FDA

**Press Trust of India**  
Mumbai

The Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration has suspended the licences of 14 food business establishments linked to online platforms on August 13. It issued 60 improvement notices and ordered the temporary stoppage of business operations at one facility. No licence was cancelled during the drive, said the state government regulator. Of the 14 suspended licences, five belonged to Blinkit establishments, five to Zepto, two to Instamart, one to Bhagwati Stores and

one to Swinsta Ent Pvt Ltd, the FDA said. The inspections covered storage, temperature control, cleanliness, pest control, personal hygiene of food handlers, compliance with FIFO/FEFO (First In, First Out/First Expired, First Out) practices, food safety records and display of licences. The FDA said it took suspension action where it found serious non-compliance. **STORAGE CONDITIONS** The FDA said the action against establishments operated by quick commerce firms was taken under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006, and the rules and regulations framed under the legislation. The regulator asked food business operators selling and delivering food through online platforms to strictly follow prescribed standards for food safety, hygiene and storage.







